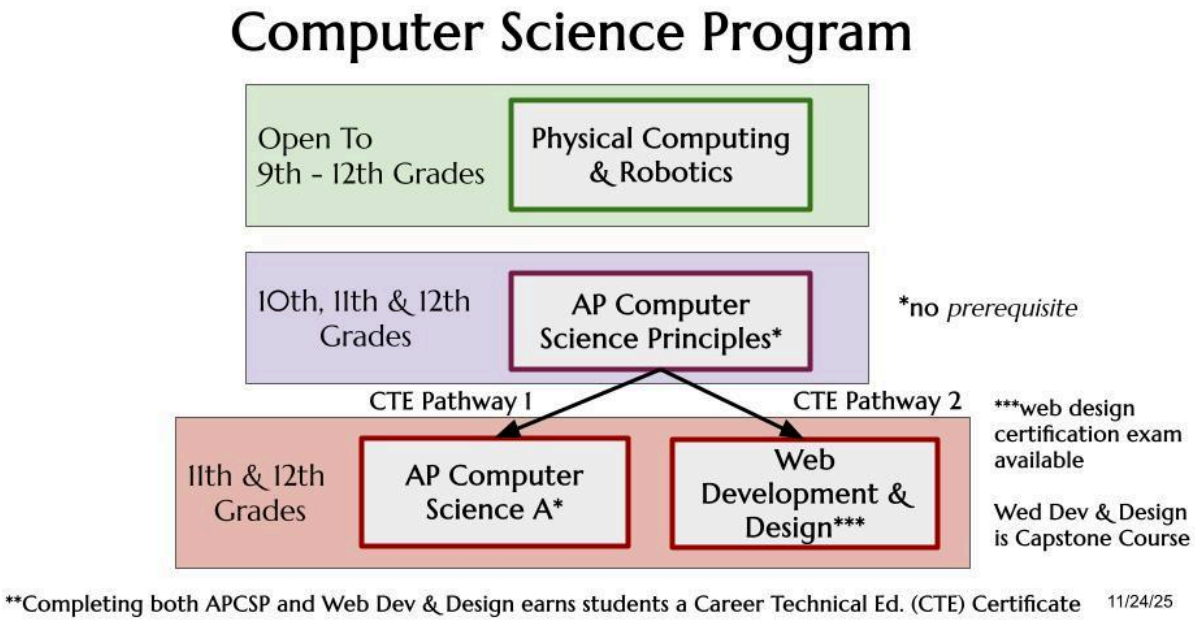
Academic Year 2026-27



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Computer Science



The Joy of Computing (5118) (UC approved "g") Year - 10 credits

Not offered in the 2026-2027 school year

Recommendation: No prerequisites but designed for students with little to no programming experience and limited knowledge of computers in general. This course is not a prerequisite for any other computer science courses.

This project-based course introduces students to the core concepts of computer programming in an engaging, friendly, and visually interactive way. The focus is on fostering creativity and problem-solving skills rather than mastering a specific programming language.

Students explore fundamental programming concepts, such as functions, abstractions, and control structures, including loops and conditional statements. These concepts are applied to hands-on projects, such as creating geometric art, building basic circuits, and developing Android mobile app and game design prototypes.

As part of the curriculum, students build a personal portfolio website using Google Sites. They also learn basic HTML and CSS. Students explore the technology and ethics of artificial intelligence, encouraging critical thinking about its impact on society. To stay connected with real-world applications, students watch and discuss videos on current events in computer science.

Physical Computing and Robotics (5135) (UC approved "g") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: No prerequisites

This is an introductory level, two-part course focused on physical computing and robotics. Part 1 of the course provides students with a hands-on, projects-based environment in building, maintaining and integrating computer systems using Raspberry Pi and its components. Students will learn how to control cameras, sensors and GPIO to do creative projects using the Python programming language. Part 2 of the course provides students with an introduction to robotics and computing including modeling, designing, planning, and programming with hands-on robotics projects using motors and sensors. Students will use VEX V5 system (or an equivalent system) as the primary robotics equipment and Python for the programming language. Topics in computer science ethics and current events are integrated into the course.

AP Computer Science Principles (5128) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

This course is open to all 10th-12th graders and has no prerequisites.
We highly recommend that if students wish to take both AP CS courses, they enroll in APCSP before APCSA.

If a student chooses to only take one computer science class, we highly recommend it be this one. This class is built around the six Computational Thinking Practices and seven Big Ideas as identified by the College Board's AP CS Principles curriculum. These concepts are using creativity, exposure to different aspects of digital information, abstraction, algorithms, programming, how the internet works, security, privacy, global impact of technology, big data analysis and our relationship to it all. Students work alone and in groups to read, research and become familiar with these fundamental computer concepts. Students use the CodeHS learning platform as their primary source of coding practice. Students complete the Create Performance Task and prepare for the multiple-choice portion of the exam. **This course fulfills the first of two-courses in the Software and Systems Development Pathway Program***

Web Design and Development (8135) (UC approved "g") Year - 10 credits

Web Design and Development will be offered for course signup but may not run, depending on interest
Recommendation: AP Computer Science Principles (5128)
Priority given to juniors and seniors.

This course is designed to provide students with the knowledge and experience needed to develop, implement, and manage effective dynamic websites. Key development concepts and tools include HTML, CSS, JavaScript as well as popular content management systems, like WordPress. **This course fulfills the second of two-courses in the Software and Systems Development Pathway Program*.** Students can obtain an industry-recognized web design exam certificate at the end of the course.

** The APCSP and Web Design and Development courses fulfill the Software and Systems Development Career Technical Education (CTE) Pathway. Students receive a CTE certificate after completing both courses. Students enrolled in the Web Design and Development course also have the opportunity to take an industry-recognized web design certification exam at the end of the course.*

AP Computer Science A (5127) (UC approved “c”) Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B+ in both semesters of APCS Principles

Students learn to design, write, and test complex programs in the Java programming language. AP Computer Science A introduces students to computer science through programming. Fundamental topics in this course include the design of solutions to problems, the use of data structures to organize large sets of data, the development and implementation of algorithms to process data and discover new information, the analysis of potential solutions, and the ethical and social implications of computing systems. The course emphasizes object-oriented programming and design using the Java programming language.

Creative Arts - Visual

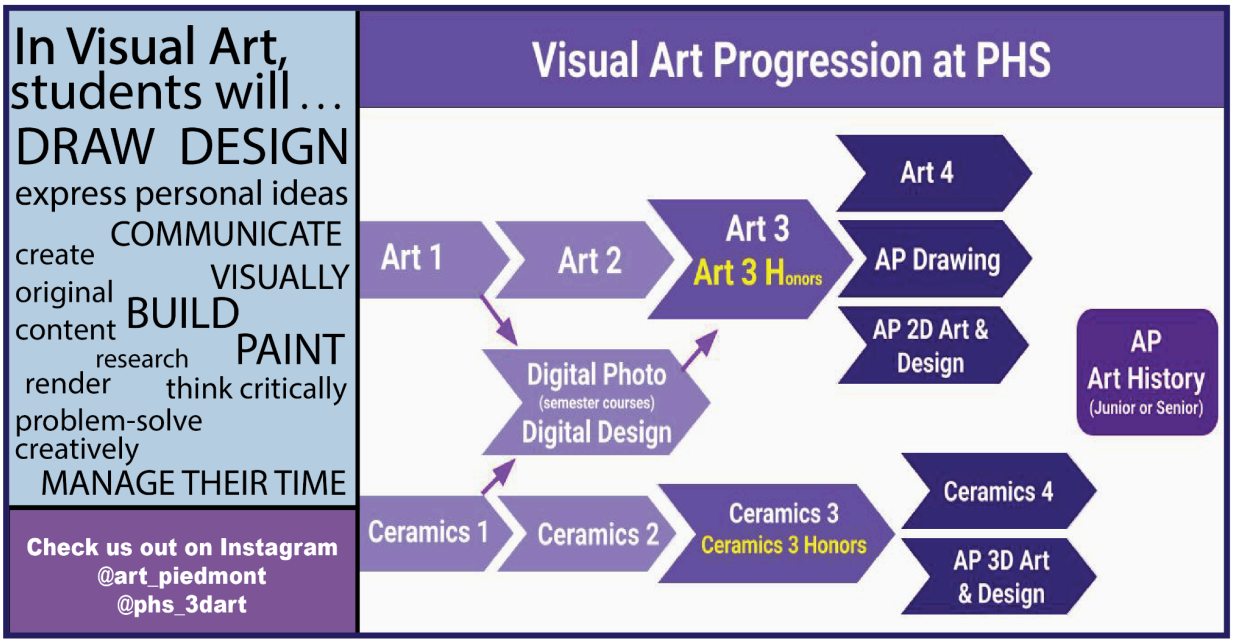


Chart updated 11/30/25

2D and 3D Art Progression FAQ

Art I (5221) **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**

Prerequisite: None

Beginning art students are introduced to drawing, painting, photography, and printmaking. Students become familiar with the elements of art and principles of design while completing a variety of projects and experimenting with different media and processes. In addition to art production, students will be introduced to art history, art criticism and aesthetics. A donation towards the cost of art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

Art II (5222) **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of Art I

Through assigned projects designed to allow more personal voice, students will continue to explore a variety of 2-D media and subject matter intended to further develop their individual skills and creativity. Media will include drawing, painting, photography, and printmaking. Students will have more sophisticated experiences in art production, art criticism and aesthetics. A donation towards the cost of art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

Digital Photography (5241) (UC approved "f") Semester - 5 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of Art I or Ceramics I

This is a semester-long course that builds technical and conceptual skill in digital photography. Using cell phone and DSLR cameras as well as Adobe Photoshop and other editing software, students will focus on studying traditional and experimental concepts in photography and post-production of images. Assignments will examine photography within cultural and historical context, explore a variety of photographic styles and concepts, and encourage development of artistic voice. Upon completion, students can advance into upper level courses like Art III and continue working with photography. If both Digital Photography & Digital Design are taken (need not be the same year) a student can earn a year of UC credit. A donation towards the cost of art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

Digital Design (5242) (UC approved "f") Semester - 5 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of Art I or Ceramics I

This is a semester long, introductory level course that works to familiarize the student with techniques and concepts in digital design. Using Adobe Creative Suite focusing on Photoshop and Illustrator, students will focus on studying traditional and experimental concepts in digital design. Assignments will examine design within cultural and historical context, and explore a variety of design styles and concepts. Upon completion, students can advance into upper level courses like Art III and continue working with digital design. If both Digital Photography & Digital Design are taken (need not be the same year) a student can earn a year of UC credit. This Spring semester course is offered during the same period as Fall Digital Photography, so that students taking the full year do not have to go through any schedule changes.

Art III (5223) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Art II or BOTH Digital Photography & Digital Design

Through more individualized instruction, greater independence, and an increased knowledge of media and techniques, students will continue to develop artwork that reflects a personal style and interpretation of concept, and build a portfolio. Further study of art criticism and aesthetics will continue to be part of the curriculum. Students work through inquiry questions in development of works that are largely of media of choice including traditional, experimental, digital, and photographic media. A donation towards the cost of art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

Honors Art III (5224) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Art II or BOTH Digital Photography & Digital Design

Honors Art 3 is a year-long course in which student artists increase knowledge of media and techniques while continuing to develop personal style and voice in their artwork. Advanced interpretation of aesthetic concepts through a variety of assignments is explored as they build a portfolio of works demonstrating strong personal expression. Students work to specialize and hone portfolios through inquiry questions in development of works that are largely of media of choice. The Honors component of the course is to create works in response to three college level prompts as well as one self designed inquiry proposal with

a body of three cohesive works supported with an artist statement for presentation at the Honors & AP Art Show in the Spring. The Spring Final is a polished digital portfolio for Common Application of Art Supplement for college. A donation towards the cost of art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

Art IV (5226) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of Art III or Honors Art III

At this level, students are expected to develop a portfolio of work that exhibits an understanding of visual relationships, aesthetics, and a variety of media. Students design their own projects, create proposals, and with the approval and direction of the instructor culminating in a body of work that reflects personal style and voice. A donation towards the cost of art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

AP 2D Art and Design (5227) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Art III or Honors Art III. Acceleration is not recommended and may only be pursued with instructor approval following the successful completion of Digital Photo & Digital Design or Art II, with an A average and a portfolio review. Students considering acceleration are strongly encouraged to enroll in Honors Art III instead.
Note: Students may take AP 2D Art and Design one year and AP Drawing the next.

The Advanced Placement Studio Art program is intended for highly motivated students committed to the serious study of art. **Students in this course may submit a 2D Design Portfolio which includes photography, design, and traditional art mediums of drawing and painting.** The majority of the course requires that students design their own artistic exploration through the creation of a cohesive body of 10 works in emulation of a studio artist. In this course, the student will produce a portfolio and submit it to the College Board. The portfolio consists of a body of work that demonstrates the student's ability to deal with the fundamental concerns of the Elements of Art and Principles of Design in a self-designed, sustained investigation so that the student may be given credit, advanced placement, or both, at the college level. A donation towards art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section. Students may take AP 2D Art and Design one year and AP Drawing the next or vice versa.

AP Drawing (5229) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Art III or Honors Art III. Acceleration is not recommended and may only be pursued with instructor approval following the successful completion of Digital Photo & Digital Design or Art II, with an A average and a portfolio review. Students considering acceleration are strongly encouraged to enroll in Honors Art 3 instead. Please Note: Students may take AP Drawing one year and AP 2D Design the next.

The Advanced Placement Studio Art program is intended for highly motivated students committed to the serious study of art. **Students in this course may submit a Drawing Portfolio which emphasizes expressive mark-making with traditional art mediums in drawing and painting as well as digital and experimental media.** The majority of the course requires that students design their own artistic exploration through the creation of a cohesive body of 10 works in emulation of a studio artist. In this

course, the student will produce a portfolio and submit it to the College Board. The portfolio consists of a body of work that demonstrates the student's ability to deal with the fundamental concerns of the Elements of Art and Principles of Design in a self-designed, sustained investigation so that the student may be given credit, advanced placement, or both, at the college level. A donation towards art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section. Students may take AP Drawing one year and AP 2D Design the next or vice versa.

Ceramics I (5211) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: None

This course introduces students to the creative and technical foundations of working with clay. Through projects that emphasize both functional and sculptural design, students will develop skills in pinch, coil, slab, and wheel-throwing techniques. Instruction also includes glaze and surface applications, safe tool use, studio maintenance and firing processes. Students will also study historical and contemporary ceramic works from diverse cultures to deepen their understanding of form, function, and artistic expression. Short term and longer term projects will be graded based on rubrics designed for each assignment. Class participation and best effort are expected on a daily basis. Students will maintain a sketchbook and a digital portfolio to document their artistic growth and creative inquiry. A donation towards clay, glazes, and art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

Ceramics II (5212) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of Ceramics I

This advanced course builds upon the techniques and concepts learned in Ceramics 1, encouraging students to refine their craftsmanship and develop a personal artistic voice. Students will explore more complex forms and processes, including advanced wheel throwing, hand-building combinations, and experimental surface treatments. Assigned projects will introduce new challenges in design and function, while student-directed works will allow for greater creative choice. Emphasis is placed on problem-solving, aesthetic decision-making, and technical mastery. Students will continue to maintain a sketchbook and digital portfolio to plan, reflect, and present their artistic growth throughout the course. A donation towards clay, glazes, and art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

Ceramics III (5213) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of Ceramics II

In this course student artists increase knowledge of the medium and techniques working with clay while continuing to develop personal style and voice in their artwork. Building on prior experience, students will design and execute self-directed projects that reflect their individual interests, technical strengths, and conceptual goals. Advanced interpretation of aesthetic concepts through a variety of assignments is explored as they build a portfolio of works demonstrating strong personal expression. Students work to specialize and hone portfolios through inquiry questions in their development of ceramic works. Students will be required to show their work in a final exhibit. A donation towards clay, glazes, and art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

Honors Ceramics III (5215) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Ceramics II

In this course student artists increase knowledge of the medium and techniques working with clay while continuing to develop personal style and voice in their artwork. Building on prior experience, students will design and execute self-directed projects that reflect their individual interests, technical strengths, and conceptual goals. Advanced interpretation of aesthetic concepts through a variety of assignments is explored as they build a portfolio of works demonstrating strong personal expression. Students work to specialize and hone portfolios through inquiry questions in their development of ceramic works. The Honors component of the course is to create works in response to three college level prompts as well as self designed inquiry proposals with a body of six total works per semester, supported with an artist statement for presentation at the Honors & AP Art Show in the Spring. The Spring Final would be a polished digital portfolio for Common Application of Art Supplement for college.

Ceramics IV (5214) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Ceramics III or Honors Ceramics III

Students continue refining their skills in various areas of ceramic construction and glazing techniques while developing their own styles. A body of work defining critical thinking and problem solving will be produced. This will be documented with a written statement and a photographed portfolio. A final written self-evaluation and exhibit will be presented at the conclusion of the year. A donation towards clay, glazes, and art supplies is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

AP 3D Art and Design (5230) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Ceramics III or Honors Ceramics III. Acceleration is not recommended and may only be pursued with instructor approval following the successful completion of Ceramics II, with an A average and a portfolio review. Students considering acceleration are strongly encouraged to enroll in Honors Ceramics III instead.

The AP Studio Art 3D Design course is an intensive art course for the motivated art student. Building upon the inquiry based work of Ceramics 3, emphasis is placed on inquiry, experimentation, and personal expression through self directed projects that demonstrate technical mastery and creative intent. Independent thinking, concept development, and documentation of artistic decisions are key components of this course. The course culminates with participation in the Honors & AP Art Show and submission of a polished digital portfolio to the College Board for AP evaluation. A donation to offset materials fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Course Fees section.

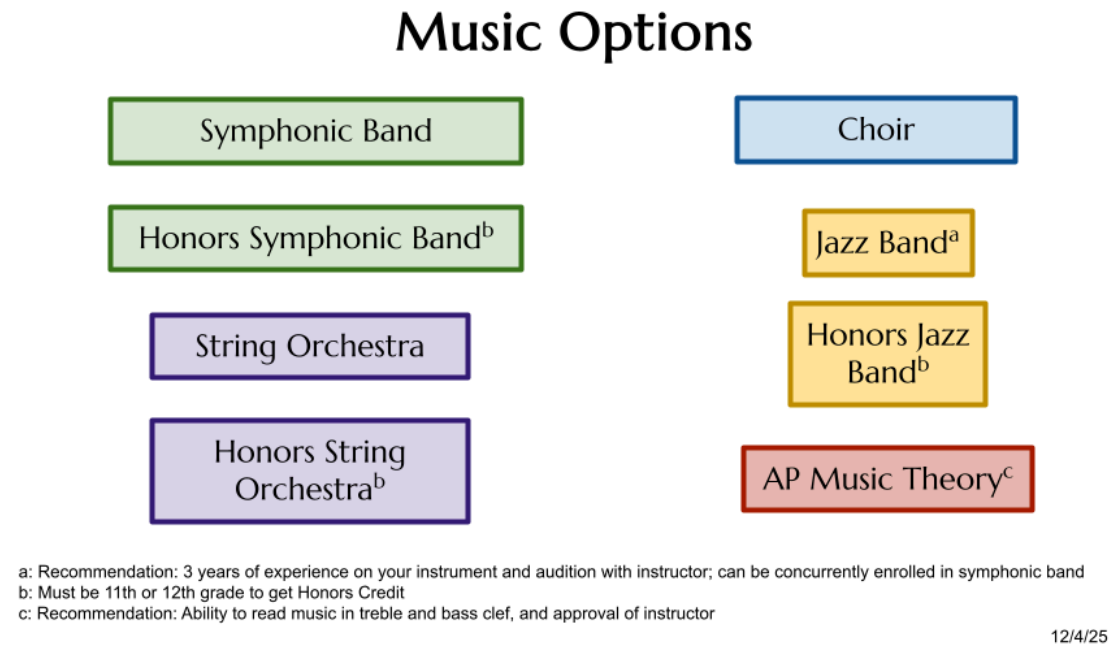
AP Art History (5231) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: Open to 11th or 12th grade students

AP Art History emphasizes a deep conceptual understanding of art historical concepts. This yearlong course is designed to be a chronological and thematic examination of art, design, and architecture.

Students will develop the essential skills of visual and contextual analysis. By examining works of art from diverse cultures and the relationships among these works, students develop an understanding of global artistic traditions. Students analyze works of art in their contexts, considering issues of patronage, gender, politics, religion, and ethnicity. The interpretation of the work of art is based upon its intended use, audience, and the role of the artist and the work of art in its particular society. Students will expand their knowledge of history, geography, politics, religion, languages, and literature, as they explore the story of people told through the art they created.

Creative Arts - Performing



Symphonic Band (5260) **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**

Recommendation: Advanced 7th/8th Grade Band or recommendation of instructor

A concert band experience for wind and percussion musicians, including several required performances. Pep Band is also a component of this course and all students enrolled in the Symphonic Band are also members of the Pep Band. Students perform in concerts, tour, and festival settings, and have the opportunity to participate in chamber music ensembles. Students are encouraged to develop their performing and listening skills by playing a variety of musical styles ranging from popular to classical. A donation for performance attire and instrument repair is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Honors Symphonic Band (5620) **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**

Prerequisite: Symphonic Band and grades 11th or 12th

In addition to the course description for Symphonic Band, this class includes a high level of dedication to playing an instrument. In order to play such music, students must be committed to attaining the music theory and technical skills needed. There will be more frequent individual playing and music theory tests. Students will be required to audition for All-State and other Honors Music Ensembles as well as participate in recitals and solo or small ensemble competitions. Specific requirements must be obtained in order to achieve the Honors credit, which is outlined in the course of study.

Jazz Band (5262) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: 3 years of experience on your instrument and audition with instructor; Completion of one year of Symphonic Band or concurrent enrollment

This course provides students with an opportunity to explore multiple musical styles including swing, Latin, rock, and funk in a performance-based setting. Students learn and practice jazz theory and improvisation and perform together in several concerts and festivals. This course also provides learning opportunities in the areas of jazz and rock history, recording arts, and composing/arranging. All instruments are encouraged to audition including guitar, bass, keyboard, and drum set. If you are hoping to take this class, please contact the teacher for further information and recommendations regarding this course and audition information. A donation for performance attire and instrument repair is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Honors Jazz Band (5263) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: Jazz Band and grades 11th or 12th

In addition to the course description for Jazz Band, this class includes a high level of dedication to playing an instrument. In order to play such music, students must be committed to attaining the music theory and technical skills needed. There will be more frequent individual playing and music theory tests. Students will be required to audition for All-State and other Honor's Music Ensembles as well as participate in recitals and solo or small ensemble competitions. Specific requirements must be obtained in order to achieve the Honors credit, which is outlined in the course of study.

String Orchestra (5265) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: Advanced 7th/8th Grade Orchestra or permission of instructor

This course provides a diverse instrumental experience for advanced string musicians. A variety of musical styles are studied, culminating in several required performances throughout the year. Two concerts are performed with the Middle School in the Winter and Spring. Participation in the school musical is an optional opportunity for students interested in collaborating with band and vocal musicians. A donation for instrument loans and instrument repair is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Honors String Orchestra (5264) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: String Orchestra and grades 11th or 12th

In addition to the course description for String Orchestra, this class includes a high level of dedication to playing an instrument. In order to play such music, students must be committed to attaining the music theory and technical skills needed. There will be more frequent individual playing and music theory tests. Students will be required to audition for All-State and other Honor's Music Ensembles as well as participate in recitals and solo or small ensemble competitions. Specific requirements must be obtained in order to achieve the Honors credit, which is outlined in the course of study.

Choir (5271) **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**

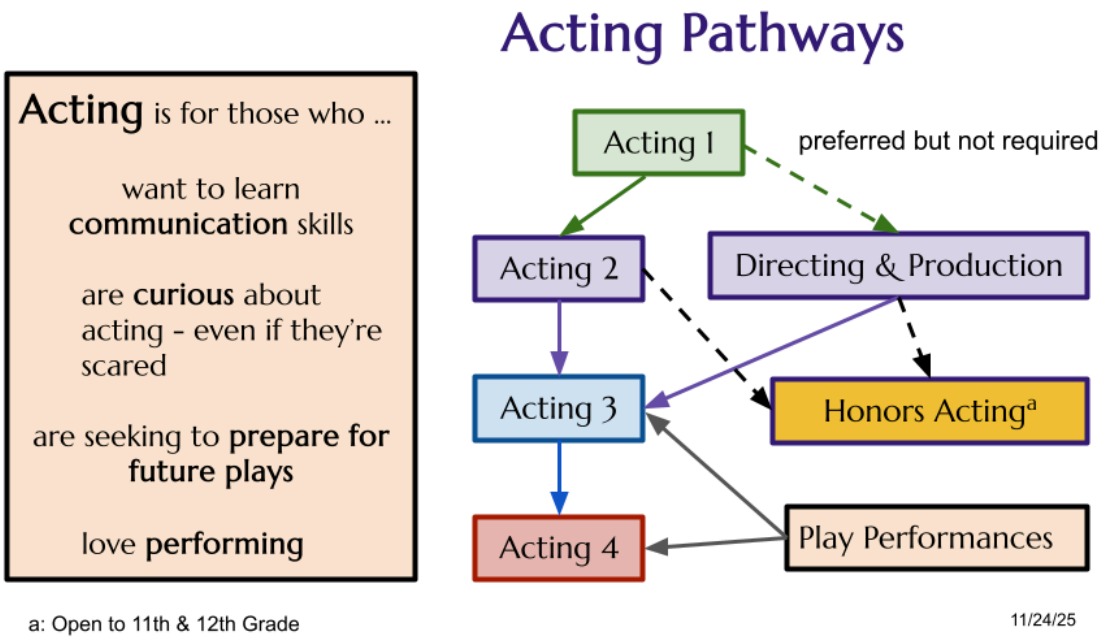
Recommendation: None

Open to all students, this is the beginning choral ensemble of the A Cappella program with an emphasis on the study of choral music literature, vocal techniques and the reading of music from classical to contemporary, pop, jazz, and world. Students perform in concerts throughout the year, including a winter concert and spring concert. Music reading skills, aural comprehension, and basic music theory concepts are stressed.

AP Music Theory (5280) **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**

AP Music Theory will be offered for course signup but may not run, depending on interest.

Students must have instrumental or vocal experience for this course in music composition, harmony, scales, keys, intervals, formal analysis, ear training, and structure of music. This course includes a historical survey of music literature, of the medieval, renaissance, classical, romantic, and jazz and 20th century styles. Students prepare for the Advanced Placement exam in Music Theory; the AP exam is optional. Students write and perform a final composition or prepare a lecture on historical style, performance practice, or overview of a major work.



Acting I (5267) **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**

Recommendation: None

This course introduces students to the fundamental skills and tools that will help them learn to be a confident speaker, listener and actor in theater and in life. Students build self-awareness, develop their imagination and concentration, recognize their emotional truth, learn acting and character analysis and vocabulary, work in teams, and expand the ability to be fully present in their voice and body within live and filmed projects. Students will also be introduced to the business/managerial careers and will explore portfolio preparation associated with live performances. No previous experience is required.

Acting II (5268) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: C or higher in both semesters of Acting I

This second year of acting expands upon the skills learned in Acting I within the performance and technical disciplines within live and filmed projects. Students study, prepare and perform scenes in various acting styles such as Greek tragedy, contemporary realism, and Wilde's British comedies. Students continue learning audition techniques and cold reading strategies, and they write and perform their own monologues and scenes in order to make connections between their lives and society.

Acting III (5269) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Acting IV (5277) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: B- or higher in both semesters of Acting II or III, and approval of teacher

These courses apply the skills in theatrical performance learned in Acting or Stage Production to create project-based performance in theater, musical theater, film and/or video production in the form of a fall and spring play. Students will prepare audition or direction portfolios, learn business/managerial skills and participate in plays from rehearsals through performance as actors and/or backstage technicians for at least two productions. They will also understand/develop a professional career plan.

Honors Acting (5278) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in Semester 2 of Acting II or Directing and Production, and grade 11th or 12th

In addition to the course description for Acting 2 (and above) or Directing and Production, this class will require a commitment that includes, but is not limited to, a selection of the options below:

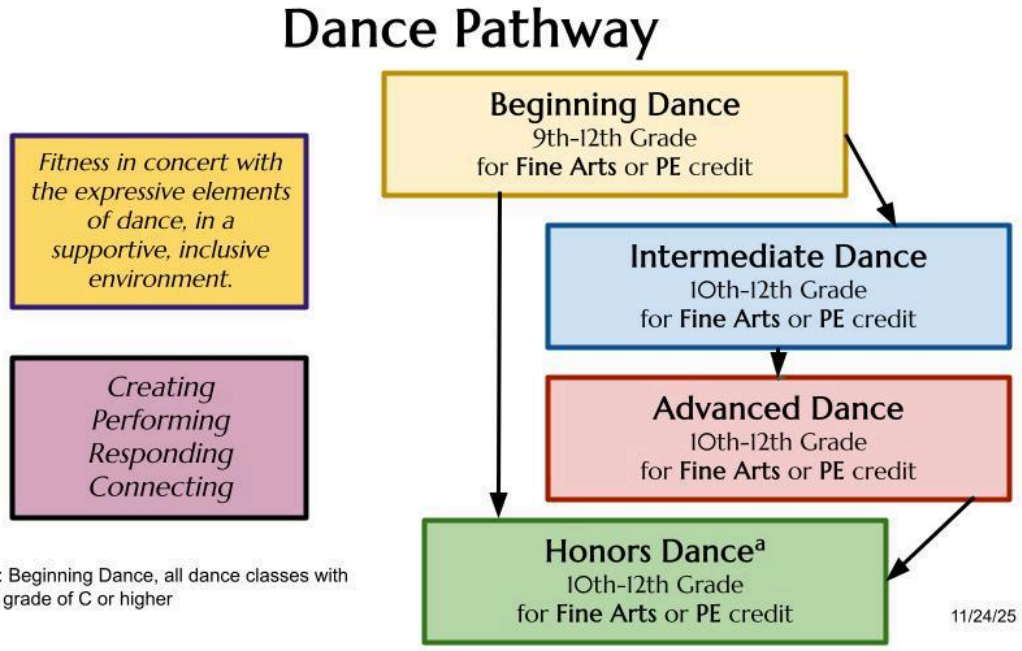
- Produce/Direct/Stage Manage a play with portfolio analysis
- Design the set/lights/props/projections/costumes/sound and manage a team
- Professional Audition
- Perform in a production or serve as an apprentice at a professional theater
- Tutor younger actors
- Write a play and submit it to a Play Festival

This is detailed in the course of study. Students will also be required to reflect on both process and producing, creating an Honors Portfolio for the year.

Directing and Production (5266) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: Acting I

This course will train students in the use and management of the various elements of technical production during a theatrical performance. These elements include the basic construction techniques for stage property and scenery, the movement of sets, scenery or lighting equipment, the management and distribution of stage properties, directing, stage management etc. Students will also be taught to manage the complex support tasks that are involved in a performance. They will explore apprenticeship and career training. This course can also integrate theater skills either for the career-oriented theater student, or for someone who wants to translate theater production skills into other careers (e.g. graphic design, writing, fashion, sound design, etc.). Much of the class will be hands-on project-based learning tailored to the students' interests and needs of the current productions with opportunities to explore apprenticeship and career training.



Beginning Dance **(5281)** **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**
(5287) **(UC approved "f")** **Semester - 5 credits**

This beginning dance class, if taken by freshmen, will fulfill students' Visual/Performing Arts requirement OR your 9th Grade Physical Education requirement. If taken by 10th-12th graders, it fulfills the Physical Education OR Visual/Performing Arts requirement.

This course introduces students to the art of dance and is designed for all students with or without previous experience. The course covers the fundamentals of ballet, jazz, modern, hip hop, world dance, social dance, and musical theater dance. Students will develop body awareness, proper alignment, motor efficiency, strength, flexibility, coordination, the ability to perform simple to more complex dance sequences, and the ability to memorize choreography. Students build skills in the execution of dance vocabulary, demonstrate an understanding of the processes and techniques used in creating and performing dance works, and ultimately create sequences of original choreography to be performed in

both the Fall and Spring dance concerts, which showcase individual creativity. All Beginning Dance class members will perform in the dance productions. All dance class members will be cast in the ensemble of the annual PHS/MHS musical, if they wish, without auditioning. The musical is extracurricular and not a requirement of the dance class. If interested in anything other than an ensemble of the musical, students will need to go through the audition process. A donation towards costumes and materials is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Intermediate Dance **(5283) or (5710) for PE credit** **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**
(5288) **(UC approved "f")** **Semester - 5 credits**

Recommendation: Successful completion of Beginning Dance.
This class fulfills the Visual/Performing Arts OR the Physical Education requirement for 10th, 11th, and 12th graders.

*Juniors and seniors enrolled in Advanced Dance for two semesters have the opportunity to be inducted into **National Honor Society for Dance Arts (NHSDA) Secondary Program**. Note that the prerequisite for enrollment in Advanced Dance is successful completion of a full year of both Beginning and Intermediate Dance. The National Honor Society for Dance Arts (NHSDA) is a program of the National Dance Education Organization (NDEO). The Mission of the NHSDA is to recognize outstanding Artistic Merit, Leadership and Academic Achievement in students studying dance in public and private schools in K-12 education, dance studios, performing arts organizations, and colleges / universities.*

This course emphasizes development of dance technique including strength, flexibility, alignment, movement quality, ability to perform more complex dance sequences, and dramatic expression in multiple dance genres such as jazz, contemporary, and ballet. Dancers will continue to increase their knowledge and skill level in hip hop, historical and world dance, yoga, and Pilates. Choreographic skills develop sophistication and a growing awareness of theme; students choreograph original, complete dance works to be performed in Fall and Spring dance concerts. All Intermediate Dance class members will perform in the dance productions. All dance class members will be cast in the ensemble of the annual PHS/MHS musical, if they wish, without auditioning. The musical is extracurricular and not a requirement of the dance class. If interested in anything other than an ensemble of the musical, students will need to go through the audition process. A donation towards costumes and materials is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Advanced Dance **(5284) or (5720) for PE credit** **(UC approved "f")** **Year - 10 credits**
(5289) **(UC approved "f")** **Semester - 5 credits**

Recommendation: Successful completion of a full year of both Beginning and Intermediate Dance.
All Advanced Dance class members are required to participate in the dance productions
This class fulfills the Visual/Performing Arts OR the Physical Education requirement for 10th, 11th, and 12th graders.

*Juniors and seniors enrolled in Advanced Dance for two semesters have the opportunity to be inducted into **National Honor Society for Dance Arts (NHSDA) Secondary Program**. (Note the prerequisites for enrollment in Advanced Dance.) The National Honor Society for Dance Arts (NHSDA) is a program of the National Dance Education Organization (NDEO). The Mission of the NHSDA is to recognize outstanding Artistic Merit, Leadership and Academic Achievement in students studying dance in public and private schools in K-12 education, dance studios, performing arts organizations, and colleges / universities.*

The Advanced dancers will focus primarily on performance preparation while continuing to strengthen technique and pursue mastery in multiple dance genres. As part of the process of becoming more

sophisticated choreographers, all advanced students will choreograph at least one complete dance piece, and all will perform in works choreographed by their peers as well as the instructor. Audition techniques as well as performance preparation and dramatic expression are emphasized. All dance class members will be cast in the ensemble of the annual PHS/MHS musical, if they wish, without auditioning. The musical is extracurricular and not a requirement of the dance class. If interested in anything other than an ensemble of the musical, students will need to go through the audition process. A donation towards costume and materials is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Honors Dance (5285) (UC approved "f") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: Beginning Dance, all dance classes with a C or higher, and grades 10th-12th

Students do not need a prior background in Dance to take Honors Dance. See instructor with questions.

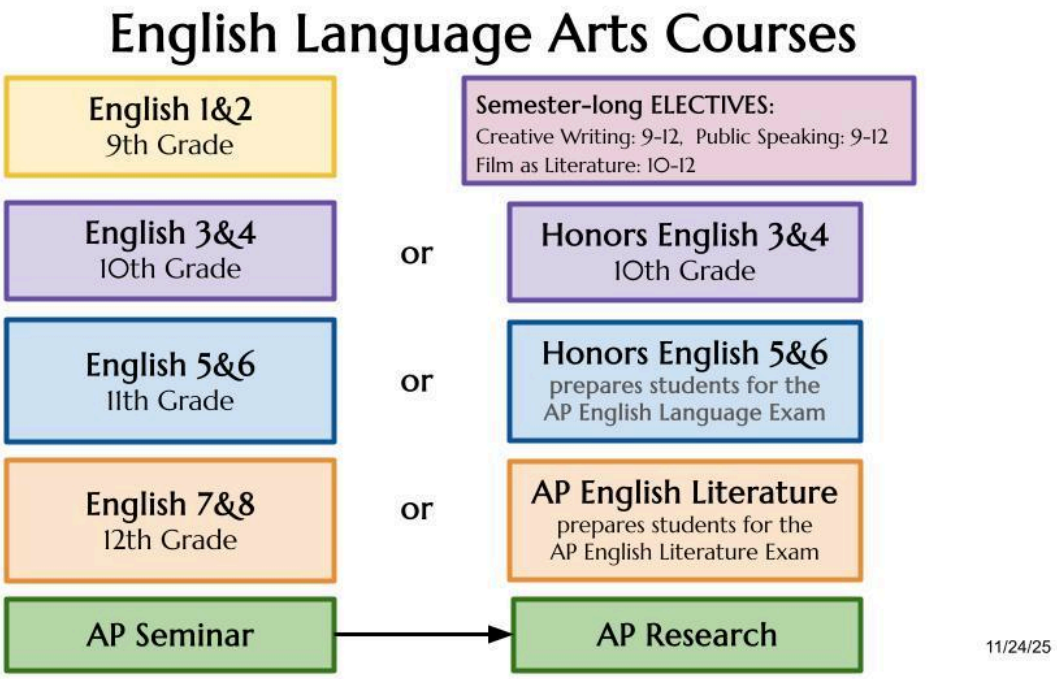
In addition to the course description for Advanced Dance (above), this class will require a commitment that includes an individualized selection of the options below:

- *Lessons in a private dance studio outside PHS or equivalent scholarly work in dance
- Apply for induction to NHSDA (National Honor Society for Dance Arts)
- Audition for an approved Summer Intensive Dance Program or equivalent scholarly work in dance
- Perform in an approved dance concert/recital/performance outside of school or equivalent scholarly work in dance
- Perform in a school dance concert
- Complete a capstone project
- Perform in a school musical
- Demonstrate mastery (through dance exams) in multiple dance genres

*Additional alternative to private dance studio instruction, if this is not an option: Regular, individualized private or small group dance instruction outside of class time with PHS Dance Instructor.

Specific requirements must be obtained in order to achieve the Honors credit, which is outlined in the course of study.

English Language Arts



English 1-2 (5300) **(UC approved "b")** **Year - 10 credits**

Required for all 9th graders

The freshman English curriculum focuses on genre study of short stories, drama, poetry, novels, and non-fiction essays. Students will not only analyze the form of the texts but also the literary elements contained within the texts. As freshmen begin to shape their place in a new school environment, they examine the themes of identity, alienation, community, maturation, and exploration, both in their own lives and in literature through class discussions and literary analysis. In addition to writing literary analysis, students will also complete an intense research project called the I Search, in which students self-select a topic, research the topic, and write a variety of pieces about it. Descriptive and analytical writing encourages students to write vividly about themselves and the world around them, but they also emphasize an attention to detail that serves them well in their analysis and evaluation of literature. A donation for purchase of one course novel for personal annotation is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

English 3-4 (5310) **(UC approved "b")** **Year - 10 credits**

Required for all 10th graders unless enrolled in Honors English 3-4

The sophomore English curriculum extends the ninth grade study of literary terms such as symbol and theme to focus on the analysis and appreciation of tone, voice, and point of view. Students explore perspective not only as a way of understanding the speaker/audience relationship in a text, but also as a

way to hone this skill in their own persuasive writing. Literature focuses on multiple points of view drawing attention to issues of gender, race, class, and community. The context of these themes often dovetails with the 10th grade World History curriculum and the analysis of these themes extends to students' own reflective writing. Students also continue the non-fiction component of writing through researching and creating public service announcements. A donation for class novels is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Honors English 3-4 (5311) (UC approved "b") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: A- in both semesters of English 1-2. Summer reading is assigned and required in advance of the course.

This is an advanced designation within the already rigorous sophomore year of English requirement. It is intended to push highly skilled students who wish for an even more challenging experience within the English 3-4 course. Earning the Honors designation requires not only mastering the content of the English 3-4 curriculum, but diving deeper, completing substantial additional reading, writing, and technical work beyond the regular coursework. Success in Honors will depend on meeting a higher standard for writing, argumentation, mastery of material, and class participation. A donation for class novels is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

English 5-6 (5325) (UC approved "b") Year - 10 credits

Required for all 11th graders unless enrolled in Honors English 5-6

The junior English curriculum focuses on American Literature, dovetailing with the concurrent U.S. History course. In this context, students examine the issues of justice, democracy, idealism, and power. As they explore the complexities of what it means to be an American, they examine the effects of race, gender, and class. Analysis of such themes is far more complex than at previous grade levels, as students delve into style, structure, and diction in their close reading and analytical writing. Through both class discussions and reflective writing they will also strive toward a higher level of analysis; as they explore the characters' relationships to society, they develop a deeper understanding of their own connections to their world. A donation for class novels is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Honors English 5-6 (5330) (UC approved "b") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: A- in both semesters of English 3-4 or Honors English 3-4. Summer reading is assigned and required in advance of the course.

This is an advanced class for juniors and satisfies the junior year of English requirement. This advanced course is intended to push already skilled students who wish to dive deeper into their language arts abilities to become critical readers of American prose written in a variety of rhetorical contexts, and become skilled writers who compose for a variety of purposes. Both their writing and their reading will make students aware of the interactions between a writer's purpose, audience expectations, and subjects, as well as the way conventions and the resources of language contribute to effectiveness in writing. College credit may be obtained only by scoring a 3 or above on the Advanced Placement exam in

English Language and Composition administered in the Spring. A donation for class novels is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

English 7-8 (5340) (UC approved "b") Year - 10 credits

Required for all 12th graders unless enrolled in AP English Literature.

The Senior English curriculum connects and synthesizes the skills and ideas introduced in the previous grade levels. Students learn to look beyond the themes in an individual text and to appreciate the text as a reflection of a larger movement or school of thought (e.g., existentialism and romanticism). In addition, students read literary criticism in order to improve critical thinking skills. As they prepare to shape their own independent lives, seniors explore the search for self in literature. A donation for class novels is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

AP English Literature (5350) (UC approved "b") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: A- in both semesters of English 5-6 or Honors English 5-6. Summer reading is assigned and required in advance of the course.

The Advanced Placement English curriculum follows the requirements of a college level English course, one in which students read widely and in depth, and engage in high level discussions of their critical, close reading. In both their discussion and writing, students will examine the way in which a text is written rather than what the text is "about," focusing on technique and style more than plot and theme. Although the readings vary from year to year, AP English focuses mainly on poetry and emphasizes works preceding the 20th century. This AP course emphasizes literary analysis in precise focused writing; through speaking, listening and reading, but mainly through their own writing, students become more aware of the resources of language. While concentrating on works of recognized literary merit, students develop their critical capacity for the independent appreciation and analysis of any literary work. College credit may be obtained by scoring a 3 or above on an Advanced Placement Test administered in the Spring. A donation for class novels is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Creative Writing (5367) (UC approved "g") Sem - 5 credits

Recommendation: None

This is a course designed for students who are passionate about writing and serious about developing their creative writing skills. Students will have the opportunity to work in several genres, including short fiction, poetry, stage plays, screenplays, and creative non-fiction. Students should expect to write a great deal in a workshop environment that includes receiving regular feedback from peers and the instructor.

Public Speaking (5377) (UC approved "g") Sem - 5 credits

Recommendation: None

This course is designed to help students become more confident public speakers while learning the basics of proper speaking techniques, including breath and vocal control, anxiety management, and the use of classical rhetorical tools. Students will create individual speeches, perform impromptu speeches, play games designed to improve "thinking on their feet," and will learn oral interpretation of literature.

Film As Literature (5387) (UC approved "g") Sem - 5 credits

Open to 11th or 12th grade students only

Learning to read visual media is a critical skill in our modern digital culture, and a natural progression from classic literary analysis. In this course, students will use the literary terminology and analytical techniques they've learned in their English classes to critically explore the movies that have contributed to our social and intellectual identities. The class will also watch and critically analyze film techniques, screenwriting choices, sound design, and directorial decisions, and maybe use what they have learned to produce their own media.

AP Seminar (5961) (UC approved "b") Year - 10 credits

Open to 10th - 12th grade students

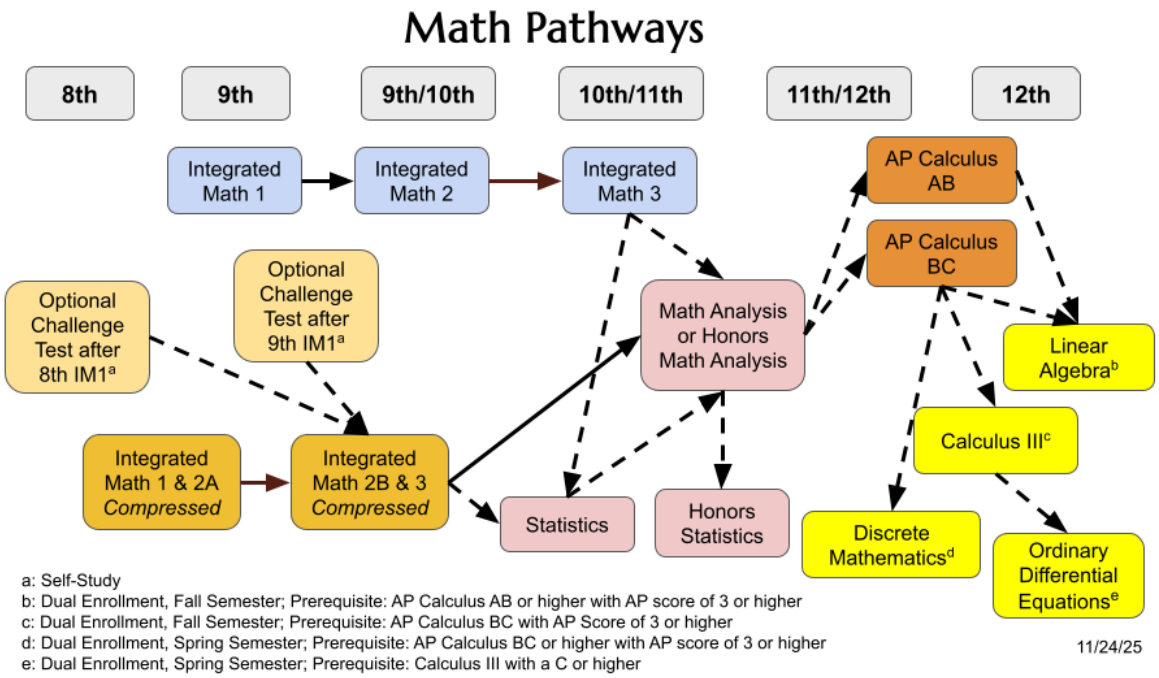
The description for this course appears in the Non-Departmental section.

AP Research (5965) (UC approved "b") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: C- or higher in both semesters of AP Seminar

The description for this course appears in the Non-Departmental section.

Mathematics



Integrated Math 1 (5625) **(UC approved "c")** **Year - 10 credits**

Prerequisite: Completion of Math 8 or equivalent course.

IM1 is a standard-paced integrated math course. It is the first in the standard four-year high school math progression (IM1 - IM2 - IM3 - Math Analysis). As an integrated math course, the content of IM1 features both algebraic and geometric approaches to solving problems. Key concepts include functions (linear and exponential), geometric transformations and congruence, geometric constructions, linear systems of equations, linear inequalities, and triangle congruence. This class covers the material in the Model Mathematics I course of the Integrated Pathway in the Common Core State Standards for Mathematics for California Public Schools. The Standards for Mathematical Practice will also be woven throughout lessons, student practice assignments, and assessments.

Integrated Math 1/2A (5626) **(UC approved "c")** **Year - 10 credits**

Prerequisite: A- or higher in Math 8 or equivalent. Please consult with your Middle school instructor.

IM1/2A is a fast-paced integrated math course that requires a great deal of independent work and a very strong understanding of prior mathematical content. It is the first course in the accelerated three-year high school math progression (IM1/2A - IM2B/3 - Math Analysis). As an integrated math course, the content of IM1/2A features both algebraic and geometric approaches to solving problems. Key concepts include functions (linear, exponential, and quadratic), geometric transformations and congruence, geometric constructions, linear systems of equations, angle relationships, attributes of polygons, triangle congruence, similarity, right triangle relationships, and trigonometry. This class covers the material in the

Model Mathematics I course as well as portions of the Model Mathematics II course of the Integrated Pathway in the Common Core State Standards for Mathematics for California Public Schools. The Standards for Mathematical Practice will also be woven throughout lessons, student practice assignments, and assessments.

Integrated Math 2 (5628) (UC approved "c") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of IM1 or equivalent

IM2 is a standard-paced integrated math course. It is the second in the standard four-year high school math progression (IM1 - IM2 - IM3 - Math Analysis). As an integrated math course, the content of IM2 features both algebraic and geometric approaches to solving problems, Key concepts include functions (quadratic), nonlinear systems of equations, complex numbers, area, volume, surface area, permutations, combinations, and geometric proofs. This class covers the material in the Model Mathematics II course of the Integrated Pathway in the Common Core State Standards for Mathematics for California Public Schools. The Standards for Mathematical Practice will also be woven throughout lessons, student practice assignments, and assessments.

Integrated Math 2B/3 (5267) (UC approved "c") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in all semesters of IM1 and 2A (or combined IM1/2A) or equivalent course(s) with or completion of the Challenge Exam with a score of 90 or higher.

IM2B/3 is a fast-paced integrated math course that requires a great deal of independent work and a very strong understanding of prior mathematical content. It is the second course in the accelerated three-year high school math progression (IM1/2A - IM2B/3 - Math Analysis). As an integrated math course, the content of IM2B/3 features both algebraic and geometric approaches to solving problems. Key concepts include circles, proof, properties of circles (geometric and algebraic), area, volume, surface area, nonlinear systems of equations, transforming families of graphs, inverse functions, logarithms, trigonometry, polynomial functions, rational equations, systems of equations in three variables, and complex numbers. This class covers portions of the material in the Model Mathematics II course as well as the material of the Model Mathematics III course of the Integrated Pathway in the Common Core State Standards for Mathematics for California Public Schools. The Standards for Mathematical Practice will also be woven throughout lessons, student practice assignments, and assessments.

Integrated Math 3 (5631) (UC approved "c") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of IM2 or equivalent

IM3 is a standard-paced integrated math course. It is the third course in the standard four-year high school math progression (IM1 - IM2 - IM3 - Math Analysis). As an integrated math course, the content of IM3 features both algebraic and geometric approaches to solving problems. Key concepts include nonlinear systems of equations, transforming families of graphs, inverse functions, logarithms, trigonometry, polynomial functions, rational equations, systems of equations in three variables, and complex numbers. This class covers the material in the Model Mathematics III course of the Integrated Pathway in the Common Core State Standards for Mathematics for California Public Schools. The Standards for Mathematical Practice will also be woven throughout lessons, student practice assignments, and assessments.

Integrated Math 1/2/3 Lab (5624) Year - 10 credits

Not offered in the 2026-2027 school year

May only be taken concurrently with IM1, IM2, or IM3.

This elective class is designed to offer additional support for students enrolled in Integrated Math classes. It is graded on a pass/fail basis. Integrated Math 1/2/3 Lab includes both pre-teaching and review of concepts taught in IM1, IM1/2, IM2, IM2/3, and IM3. It also provides teacher assisted homework support.

Statistics (5666) (UC approved "c") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of IM 2B/3 or IM3 or equivalent

Statistics acquaints students with major concepts and tools for collecting, analyzing, and drawing conclusions from data. Students frequently work on assignments involving hands-on gathering and analysis of real-world data. Ideas and computations presented in this course have immediate links and connections with actual events. Students often use calculators and computers to present and analyze data.

Honors Statistics (5667) (UC approved "c") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Math Analysis or Honors Math Analysis

This course offers a more extensive, technical and in-depth study of the topics covered in the standard Statistics course. It will prepare students to take the AP Statistics exam in the Spring. It is intended for students who are extremely competent in mathematics and comfortable reasoning with quantity in various contexts. Students should also be willing and able to learn statistical concepts and processes presented in the course readings. Comprehensive exams will be given on a regular basis. Each semester, there will be a comprehensive final exam.

Math Analysis (5649) (UC approved "c") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: C or higher in both semesters of IM 2B/3 or IM3 or equivalent

This is a college preparatory course for students planning to take more advanced math and science courses. It includes all mathematical skills and concepts needed to prepare students for college-level calculus. Students will demonstrate their math competencies algebraically, numerically, graphically and verbally. Specific topics include a review of functions (polynomial, exponential, logarithmic and rational) and their applications, trigonometric equations and applications, polar forms, conic sections, matrices, and limits of series. The Standards for Mathematical Practice will be woven throughout lessons, problem sets and assessments. Assessments will include unit exams and mid-unit quizzes.

Honors Math Analysis (5650) (UC approved "c") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: A in both semesters of 2B/3 or IM3

This course offers a more extensive, technical and in-depth study of the topics covered in the standard Math Analysis course. It is intended for students who are extremely competent in mathematics and interested in pursuing a career in math or science. Problem sets are challenging and require students to prove relationships and clearly explain their reasoning. Comprehensive exams will be given on a regular basis. Each semester, there will be a comprehensive final exam.

AP Calculus AB (5660) (UC approved "c") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Math Analysis or Honors Math Analysis

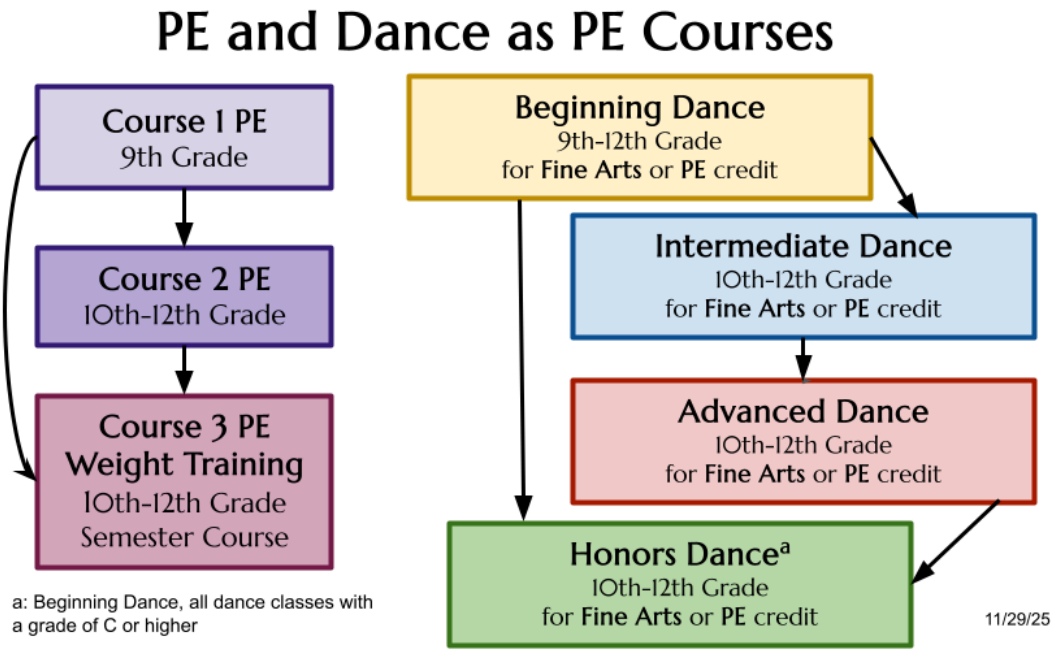
Calculus AB is an Advanced Placement course, equivalent to a first semester college calculus course, which prepares students for technical and scientific studies as well as other areas of study that require advanced math. Students will develop both a mechanical and conceptual understanding of a variety of topics, which involve differential and integral calculus and apply concepts to real-world situations. Students prepare for the AP Calculus AB exam in Spring. ***Students who sign up for AP Calc AB will be required to complete a summer review assignment prior to the course.***
Note: This course is not a traditional pathway to AP Calculus BC. Students should take AP Calculus BC directly.

AP Calculus BC (5661) (UC approved "c") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: A in both semesters of Math Analysis or A- or higher both semesters of Honors Math Analysis
Note: This course is not the traditional pathway for AP Calculus AB students. Students should speak with their counselor if this need arises.

Calculus BC is an Advanced Placement course, equivalent to a full year college calculus course, which prepares students for technical and scientific studies, as well as other areas of study that require advanced math. Students will develop both a mechanical and conceptual understanding of a variety of topics, which involve differential and integral calculus and apply concepts to real-world situations. Students prepare for the AP Calculus BC exam in Spring. The pace of this course is quite brisk, and student work outside class will be extensive (4-8 hours per week). Students who take AP Calculus BC should be confident in their math skills, excited for a challenge, and be able to complete work independently. Students should also weigh their other time commitments for the school year in deciding if this course is right for them. ***Students who sign up for AP Calc BC will be required to complete a summer assignment prior to the course with a quiz in the first week of school.***

Physical Education



Students are required to meet their Physical Education credit requirements by the end of their junior year.

Course 1 PE: Freshmen (5700S1 & 5700S2) **Year - 10 credits**

All freshmen are required to take this course, unless enrolled in Beginning Dance, and participate in California Physical Fitness Testing (PFTs)

Following the CA state Physical Education Standards, this class emphasizes knowledge and motor skill competencies with an emphasis on individual and dual sport activities, rhythms and dance, and group dynamics. Fitness, strength building, and health are emphasized through regular vigorous physical activity as well as demonstrating knowledge of fitness concepts, principles, and strategies. Self-responsibility, social interaction, and group dynamics are demonstrated through understanding psychology and sociology concepts applied to the strategies around performance and physical activity. The overall goal is to increase physical competence, health-related fitness, self-responsibility and enjoyment of physical activity for all students. The course prepares students to think critically about their overall fitness and the benefits of being a lifelong fitness participant. Students will participate in a variety of single and dual sports as well as aspects of team sports. Lead-up games and skill acquisition and improvement will be emphasized as well. Students will also learn about the fundamentals of strength training and mechanics of lifting, heart rate, cardiovascular fitness and endurance, goal setting, core bodywork, resistance band and dynamic stretching. *A donation for uniform is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Course 2 PE: Sophomore to Senior (5730S1 & 5730S2) Sem - 5 credits

Following the CA State Physical Education Standards, this course emphasizes group sports and activities, social etiquette of sports, basic understanding of the principles of movement, and the importance physical activity has on the quality of their lives. The content articulates the knowledge, skills, and confidence students need to maintain meaningful physical activity throughout their lifetime. *A donation for uniform is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Course 3 PE: Weight Training - Sophomore to Senior (5733) Sem - 5 credits

Prerequisite: Completion of Course 1 and passing 5 out of 6 PFT standards
Preference is given to upperclassmen in need of fulfilling graduation requirements

This course is designed for students to gain an understanding of the proper mechanics of eccentric and concentric movement during resistance/strength training as it pertains to the 5 Components of Physical Fitness and the Overload Principle. Building off Course 1 and Course 2, students engage in weight training, agility drills, and flexibility exercises. Students utilize both free weights and circuit training weight machines. Students learn how to build a fitness plan in connection to their muscular and skeletal anatomy, in order to advance their own physical fitness level and to learn the benefits of weight training in their lives, now and in the future. *A donation for uniform is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

PE Athletics Sem - 5 credits

PUSD allows for 2 sports per school year to be eligible for PE credit. See sports list and codes below.

Upperclassmen who participate in a PHS sponsored California Interscholastic Federation sport may receive credit for Physical Education on the basis of one sport being the equivalent to one semester of Physical Education. You must sign up for the sports you would like to participate in during the year (e.g. if you play football, you would sign up for 5746 – Football). If you sign up for a specific sport and fail to make the team, you must see your counselor immediately. If a student is declared ineligible due to attendance or discipline, then it is up to the Principal's discretion (based on amount of time and other factors) as to whether PE credit will be issued. A student who is academically ineligible due to a GPA of less than 2.0 will not receive PE credit. A donation toward coaches' stipends is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

****You will not be able to choose PE Athletics during Course Selection. Once your name is on the roster for a team, it will be added to your schedule****

Fall Semester	
Girls' Volleyball	5740
Girls' Golf	5741
Girls' Tennis	5742
Boys' Water Polo	5743
Girls' Water Polo	5744
Cross Country	5745
Football	5746
Flag Football	5763

Spring Semester	
Girls' Basketball	5748
Girls' Soccer	5749
Boys' Basketball	5750
Boys' Soccer	5751
Boys' Tennis	5754
Boys' Golf	5753
Boys' Lacrosse	5755
Girls' Lacrosse	5756
Baseball	5757
Softball	5758
Track & Field	5759
Swimming/Diving	5760
Badminton	5762
Boys' Volleyball	5739
Beach Volleyball	5765

PE: Beginning Dance (5715) — Year - 10 credits
Beginning Dance (5716) — Semester - 5 credits

Recommendation: None
Beginning class, if taken by freshmen, will fulfill your Visual/Performing Arts requirement OR your Physical Education requirement.

This course introduces students to the art of dance and is designed for all students with or without previous experience. The course covers the fundamentals of ballet, jazz, modern, hip hop, world dance, social dance, and musical theater dance. Students will develop body awareness, proper alignment, motor efficiency, strength, flexibility, coordination, the ability to perform simple to more complex dance sequences, and the ability to memorize choreography. Students build skills in the execution of dance vocabulary, demonstrate an understanding of the processes and techniques used in creating and performing dance works, and ultimately create original dance works to be performed in both the Fall and Spring dance concerts that showcase individual creativity. All Beginning Dance class members will perform in the dance productions. All dance class members will be cast in the ensemble of the annual PHS/MHS musical, if they wish, without auditioning. The musical is extracurricular and not a requirement of the dance class. If interested in anything other than an ensemble of the musical, students will need to go through the audition process. A donation towards costume and materials is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

PE: Intermediate Dance (5710) — Year - 10 credits
Intermediate Dance (5712) — Semester - 5 credits

Recommendation: Successful completion of Beginning Dance
This class fulfills the Visual/Performing Arts OR the Physical Education requirement for 10th, 11th, and 12th graders.

This course emphasizes the development of dance technique including strength, flexibility, alignment, movement quality, ability to perform more complex dance sequences, and dramatic expression in multiple dance genres such as jazz, contemporary, and ballet. Dancers will continue to increase their knowledge

and skill level in hip hop, historical and world dance, yoga, and Pilates. Choreographic skills develop sophistication and a growing awareness of themes. All Intermediate Dance class members will perform in the dance productions. All dance class members will be cast in the ensemble of the annual PHS/MHS musical, if they wish, without auditioning. The musical is extracurricular and not a requirement of the dance class. If interested in anything other than an ensemble of the musical, students will need to go through the audition process. A donation towards costume and materials is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

PE: Advanced Dance (5720) — Year - 10 credits
Advanced Dance (5724) — Semester - 5 credits

Recommendation: Successful completion of a full year of both Beginning and Intermediate Dance.
All Advanced Dance class members are required to participate in the dance productions
This class fulfills the Visual/Performing Arts OR the Physical Education requirement for 10th, 11th, and 12th graders.

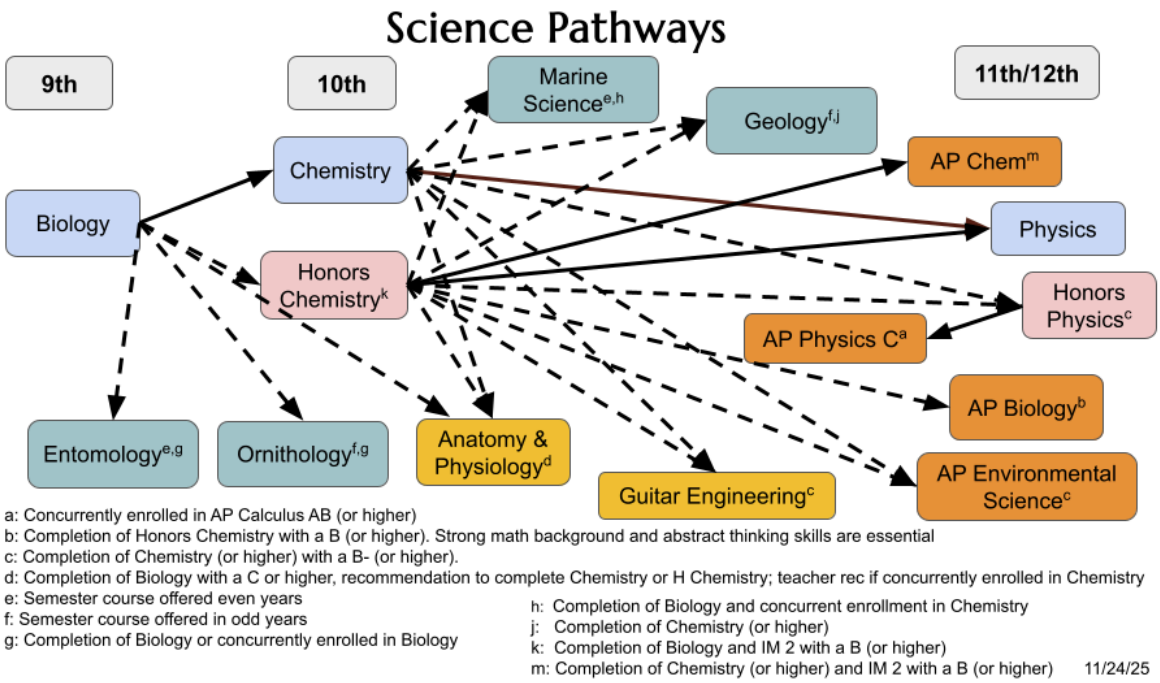
The advanced dancers will focus primarily on performance preparation while continuing to strengthen technique and pursue mastery in multiple dance genres. As part of the process of becoming more sophisticated choreographers, all advanced students will choreograph at least one complete dance piece, and all will perform in works choreographed by their peers as well as the instructor. Audition techniques as well as performance preparation and dramatic expression are emphasized. All dance class members will be cast in the ensemble of the annual PHS/MHS musical, if they wish, without auditioning. The musical is extracurricular and not a requirement of the dance class. If interested in anything other than an ensemble of the musical, students will need to go through the audition process. A donation towards costume and materials is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

PE: Honors Dance (5285) — Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: Beginning Dance, all dance classes with a C or higher, and grades 10th-12th

The description for this course appears in the Creative Arts, Performing section

Science



Biology and The Living Earth (5820) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: None

This required course will explore major biological concepts from a phenomenon-based approach. Biology is the first course in a three course NGSS sequence. Students will gain an appreciation of the natural world as they study phenomena such as superbugs, identical and fraternal twins, oceanic dead zones, cancer clusters and the search for extraterrestrial life. Earth and space science concepts are integrated into the curriculum to enhance student understanding of the interconnectedness between organisms and their environment. Students will engage in hands-on activities, experimentation, data analysis and apply engineering principles. Upon successful completion of this course, students will have a strong foundation for taking upper level science courses. A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Chemistry in the Earth System (5853) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: Completion of Biology

This course is specifically directed towards college-bound students who will be non-science majors. This is the second course in a three-course sequence. It is unique in its strong emphasis on learning chemical principles as they apply to real life, as it is centered on chemistry-related technological issues now confronting our society and the world. It is intended to help students realize the important role that chemistry plays in their personal and professional lives, to use principles of chemistry to think more

intelligently about current issues they will encounter involving science and technology, and to develop a lifelong awareness of the potential and limitations of science of technology. The course incorporates various phenomena that occur on Earth and throughout the solar system to help explain, understand and apply the chemistry curriculum. A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Honors Chemistry (5854) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Biology and IM 2.

This is a rigorous college preparatory course intended for students who will take chemistry in college and/or who plan to enter science-related fields; a college level text is used. This is the second course in a three-course sequence. Students must be self-directed and have strong study skills. They need to spend at least 5 hours per week preparing for class. Students develop the basic chemical foundation required for the AP Biology course. Lab experiments are a focus and will emphasize the problem-solving approach to the basic ideas of atomic theory, chemical change, energy effects and descriptive chemistry. Students design and carry out several of their own experiments. The course incorporates phenomena that occur on Earth and throughout the solar system to help explain, understand and elucidate the chemistry curriculum. A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Guitar Engineering (5863) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: Completion of Chemistry in the Earth System/Honors Chemistry in the Earth System, Integrated Math 2

The description for this course appears in the Non-Departmental section

Physics of the Universe (5858) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: Completion of Biology and Chemistry or Honors Chemistry

Throughout this course, students will engage with phenomena and design challenges to make sense of abstract physical principles, such as wave/particle duality and electromagnetic fields, and complex earth and space science phenomena, such as stellar evolution and Earth's internal structure. The rigor of this course will prepare students for collegiate studies in physics and for engaging in civic discourse around socio-scientific issues, such as human impacts on the environment. Students will demonstrate their ability to use this knowledge in a wide range of formative and summative assessment tasks. A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Honors Physics of the Universe (5859) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher both semesters of IM2 or equivalent and B or higher in both semesters of Chemistry or Honors Chemistry

Throughout this course, students will engage with phenomena and design challenges to make sense of abstract physical principles, such as wave/particle duality and electromagnetic fields, and complex earth and space science phenomena, such as stellar evolution and Earth's internal structure. The rigor of this course will prepare students for collegiate studies in physics and for engaging in civic discourse around socio-scientific issues, such as human impacts on the environment. Students will demonstrate their ability to use this knowledge in a wide range of formative and summative assessment tasks. This honors course includes the foundational phenomena and themes of the standard Physics of the Universe course but increases the conceptual demand on students. A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

AP Physics C: Mechanics (5860) (UC approved "d") Semester - 5 credits

Prerequisite: Completion of AP Calculus AB or concurrent enrollment in AP Calculus BC
Recommended: B or higher in both semesters of Physics or Honors Physics
Note: AP Physics C: Mechanics is designed to be taken with AP Physics C: Electricity & Magnetism

AP Physics C: Mechanics is a calculus-based introductory college-level physics course. Students cultivate their understanding of physics by developing models of physical phenomena through inquiry-based investigations.

Students build their understanding of physical models as they explore and solve problems in these topics:

- Kinematics
- Forces and Translational Dynamics
- Work, Energy, and Power
- Linear Momentum
- Torque and Rotational Dynamics
- Energy and Momentum of Rotating Systems
- Oscillations

Laboratory Requirement

This course requires that 25 percent of instructional time be spent in hands-on laboratory work, with an emphasis on inquiry-based investigations that provide students with opportunities to demonstrate the foundational physics principles and apply the science practices.

Inquiry-based laboratory experiences support the AP Physics C: Mechanics course and AP Course Audit curricular requirements by providing opportunities for students to engage in the science practices as they design plans for experiments, make predictions,collect and analyze data, apply mathematical routines, develop explanations, and communicate about their work.

Colleges may require students to present their laboratory materials from AP science courses before granting college credit for laboratory work, so students should be encouraged to retain their laboratory notebooks, reports, and other materials.

AP Physics C: Electricity & Magnetism (5861) (UC approved "d") Semester - 5 credits

Prerequisite: Completion of AP Calculus AB or concurrent enrollment in AP Calculus BC
Recommended: B or higher in both semesters of Physics or Honors Physics
Note: AP Physics C: Electricity & Magnetism is designed to be taken with AP Physics C: Mechanics

AP Physics C: Electricity & Magnetism is a calculus-based introductory college-level physics course. Students cultivate their understanding of physics by developing models of physical phenomena through inquiry-based investigations.

Students build their understanding of physical models as they explore and solve problems in these topics:

- Electric Charges, Fields, and Gauss's Law
- Electric Potential
- Conductors and Capacitors
- Electric Circuits
- Magnetic Fields and Electromagnetism
- Electromagnetic Induction

Laboratory Requirement

This course requires that 25 percent of instructional time be spent in hands-on laboratory work, with an emphasis on inquiry-based investigations that provide students with opportunities to demonstrate the foundational physics principles and apply the science practices.

Inquiry-based laboratory experiences support the AP Physics C: Electricity & Magnetism course and AP Course Audit curricular requirements by providing opportunities for students to engage in the science practices as they design plans for experiments, make predictions,collect and analyze data, apply mathematical routines, develop explanations, and communicate about their work.

Colleges may require students to present their laboratory materials from AP science courses before granting college credit for laboratory work, so students should be encouraged to retain their laboratory notebooks, reports, and other materials.

AP Biology (5821) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of Honors Chemistry.
Recommended: Strong math background and abstract thinking skills

This rigorous course for second year Biology students follows the College Board requirements for AP Biology and is designed to be the equivalent to an introductory college course. Students will engage in laboratory work, group activities, and class discussions that are designed to give students a deep understanding of the concepts and the ability to apply them. The course focuses on the core biological themes of evolution, energy, information and interactions. Students will be prepared to take the AP Biology exam in the Spring. A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

AP Environmental Science (5830) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: B or higher in both semesters of Biology and B or higher in both semesters of Chemistry or Honors Chemistry

This rigorous, interdisciplinary, full-year course is designed to be the equivalent of an introductory college course in environmental science. Lectures, text, supplemental reading, investigations, and laboratory materials are at the introductory college level. The course focuses on the interdependence of the Earth's systems, including natural resources, environmental quality, global changes, and the ways that humans interact with these systems. Special emphasis is placed on utilizing a variety of activities to connect real world issues to the content, including laboratories and longer-term projects, case studies, field research on beach and intertidal rocky habitats, cost-benefit analyses, and current event presentations. Students will be prepared to take the AP Environmental Science exam in Spring. A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

AP Chemistry (5855) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: B or higher in both semesters of IM2 or equivalent and B or higher in both semesters of Chemistry or Honors Chemistry.

The AP Chemistry course provides students with a college-level foundation to support future advanced coursework in chemistry. Students cultivate their understanding of chemistry through inquiry-based investigations and explore the following topics: atomic structure, intermolecular forces and bonding, chemical reactions, kinetics, thermodynamics, and equilibrium. This course requires that students engage in lab investigations during 25 percent of their instructional time. This includes a minimum of 16 hands-on labs (at least six of which are inquiry-based). It is also strongly recommended that students keep a lab notebook throughout the course. A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Anatomy and Physiology (5840) (UC approved "d") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: C or higher in both semesters of Biology, completion of Chemistry or Honors Chemistry is strongly recommended and may be taken concurrently with prior approval of the instructor.
There will be a meeting at the end of May and/or near class selection time for students to observe dissections and to ask questions about the class.

The objective of the course is to provide a firm background in the fundamentals of the anatomy and physiology of the human body. Emphasis is placed on the major systems of the human body. Hands-on labs provide the main thrust of the class consisting of at least 55% of the time devoted to gross (large) dissection of the cat and other large animals' organs. The biochemistry and histology of each body system is incorporated into lectures and labs focusing on homeostasis. This course is recommended for students planning on pursuing a college program in nursing, health, therapy, veterinary, pharmacology and other related medical fields. A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Field Science Electives

The Field Science electives consist of four semester-long courses; they are entirely independent of one another, so students may take any or all of them. The sequence of four courses will be repeated every two years; **please note that for the 2026-27 school year only FSE Entomology (fall) and FSE Marine Science (spring) will be offered**. Each course involves field work roughly once every three weeks, which will sometimes extend beyond normal school hours, depending on destinations and schedules. Students are expected to attend every field trip; instructor pre-approval for absences is required.

FSE Geology (5869) (UC approved "d") Sem - 5 credits

Not offered in the 2026-2027 school year

Prerequisites: Biology and concurrent enrollment or completion of Chemistry

This course expands on the study of geology found in the other core science courses. We begin with Earth's structure and plate tectonics, then an overview of mineral formation and composition; igneous, metamorphic, and sedimentary rocks follow, then geologic time and Earth history, with connections to the evolution of life. Throughout the course there is a particular emphasis on California landforming processes such as glaciation and volcanism, so that students will gain a deeper understanding of the geology underlying their local and state communities. Field trips will include Piedmont Park, Sibley Volcanic Regional Park, Mount Diablo, and the Marin Headlands. Pending approval, there *may* be optional weekend overnight field trips such as Yosemite NP, Mammoth Mountain, or Lassen NP.

FSE Ornithology (5865) (UC approved "d") Sem - 5 credits

Not offered in the 2026-2027 school year

Prerequisite: Biology or concurrent enrollment in Biology

Ornithology is the study of birds. Birds are the only descendents of dinosaurs and they are some of Earth's most beautiful and interesting species; familiarity with them will enhance your experience in the outdoors. This course emphasizes bird identification, with regular in-class walks in Piedmont Park, as well as field trips to San Francisco Bay marsh areas and local parks. We also will delve into topics such as avian evolution, physiology (adaptations to flight), relationship to biomes, conservation, and the effects of climate change on populations. Pending approval, optional weekend day trips will occur to coastal and central valley locations.

FSE Entomology (5867) (*UC approval pending*) Sem - 5 credits

Offered fall semester 2026-2027 school year

Prerequisite: Biology or concurrent enrollment in Biology

Entomology is the study of insects. Insects and their relatives are found in every habitat on the planet, and are critical members of every biome. Some can have harmful effects on humans, but most are beneficial to us and some are required for our way of life or even survival. This course emphasizes insect identification and taxonomy (how they are related) and presents topics such as insect evolution, physiology, economic and ecological importance, conservation and control, and effects of climate change. We will do collections and observations in the field and study collected insects for identification. Field trips will be local and will vary with the season and weather. Pending approval, optional weekend day trips will occur to coastal and central valley locations.

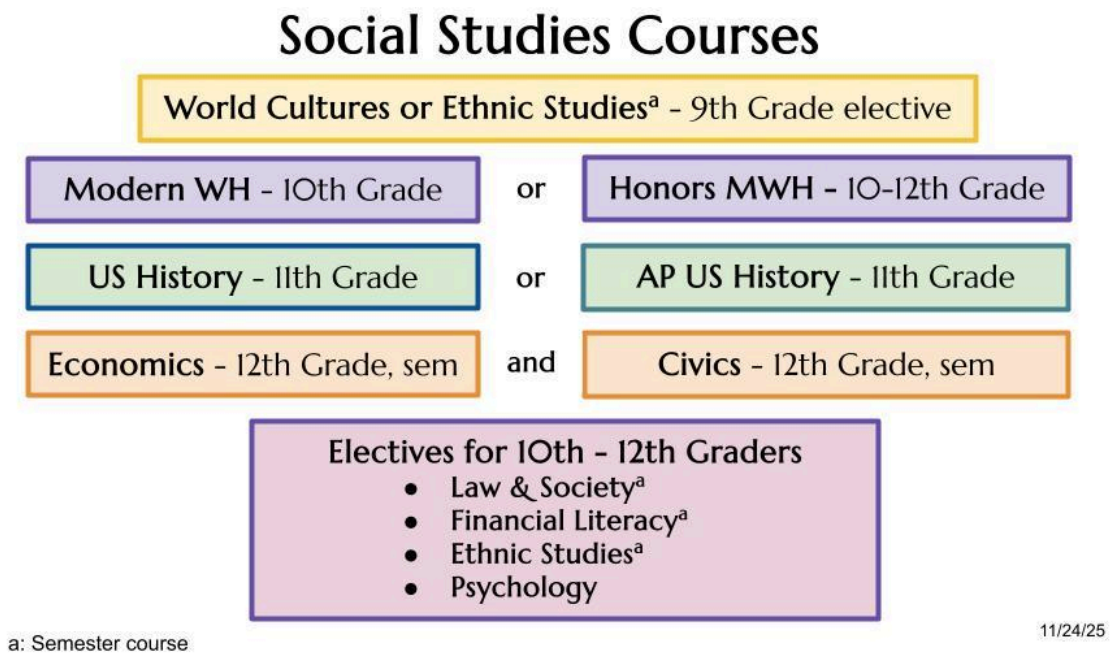
FSE Marine Science (5871) (*UC approval pending*) **Sem - 5 credits**

Offered spring semester 2026-2027 school year

Prerequisites: Biology and concurrent enrollment in or completion of Chemistry

In California we are ideally situated to explore the marine environment which covers ¾ of the Earth's surface. Marine ecosystems range from tidepools and estuaries to open oceans; surface waters full of familiar fish, birds, and mammals, to the deep seafloor, which is the least explored area on Earth. We will study the variety of these marine ecosystems and how the myriad of physical and chemical factors contribute to their complexity. We will also focus on the complicated interrelationship between the oceans and climate change. Field trips in this course will be longer than in the other electives, since our destinations will be more remote. We will spend time in tidepools, marshes, and on the bay itself, and, pending approval, optional field trips may include Monterey Bay and offshore locations.

Social Science/Studies



World Cultures and Geography (5503) **(UC approved "a")** **Year - 10 credits**

This course is only offered to 9th grade students

In this course, students will learn about the non-western world, including the Middle East, Africa, Asia, and Latin America in an active and engaging learning environment. The content of this course will explain the historical events that have shaped these regions and their roles in world affairs. Specific topics include the global economy, foreign policy, international institutions, environmental policy, and current areas of conflict around the world.

Modern World History (5559) **(UC approved "a")** **Year - 10 credits**

This course is only offered to 10th grade students

The focus of this class is the struggles and triumphs, conflicts and controversies that have surrounded people from the Enlightenment to the present. Students study modern developments in history, culture, and geography. The themes of democracy, industrialization, imperialism, nationalism, totalitarianism, war, nation-building, and human rights are examined as they emerge out of Europe and affect people around the world. In addition to content mastery, students focus on developing sophisticated critical thinking, close reading, discussion/debate, and analytical writing skills throughout the year.

Honors Modern World History (5558) (UC approved "a") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: A in both semesters of English 1-2
Recommendation: World Cultures

This is an advanced history course that will satisfy the sophomore year World History requirement. This year-long course of study will have our young Historians exploring over 500 years of global history, starting in the year 1500, as the Dark Ages in Europe are ending, but the Renaissance of the Far East is just beginning. Comparing and contrasting large factual units of global history, students will engage in the parallel worlds of the humans that came before them to apply historical trends to their own modern world. With a quick pace, and a flipped classroom, these units will allow history students to navigate the complexities of world history content through rich engagement of physical, visual, and textual materials and sources. Students will get to follow their research interests of military, sociological, literary, environmental, or political historical lenses. In addition to content mastery, students focus on developing sophisticated critical thinking, close reading, discussion/debate, and historiographic writing skills throughout the year with a variety of formal assessments, projects, Model UN simulations, and essays. Students will write their own historiographical papers on a chosen topic.

Modern U.S. History (5510) (UC approved "a") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: This course is only offered to 11th grade students

This course quickly reviews the foundations of the US through 1900, and brings topics to present day, but primarily emphasizes 20th century American history. Students work to build historical thinking skills and answer essential questions within each time period. They explore contributions by diverse people to the American experience as they consider major political issues, economic challenges, social movements, and foreign affairs from the past and relate them to contemporary events. Students examine primary documents, secondary texts, and visual sources as they work to understand major class themes, cause and consequence, continuity and change, and turning points of American history. In addition to content mastery, students focus on developing sophisticated critical thinking, close reading, discussion/debate, and analytical writing skills throughout the year.

AP U.S. History (5516) (UC approved "a") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: A in both semesters of Modern World History or B or higher in both semesters of Honors Modern World History AND A or higher in English 3-4 or B or higher in both semesters of Honors English 3-4.
Recommendation: 85% on entrance assessment

Summer Requirement: Approximately 4-6 hours of individual learning from a variety of sources including the class textbook, primary source analysis and video resources.

AP U.S. History is designed to be the equivalent of a college course of U.S. History A rigorous level of reading and writing is required, as well as a high level of in-class participation. Students develop their analytical and interpretive writing skills through short, long, and document-based essays. Students are graded according to a college level standard.

The course covers U.S. history from 1491 to the present. Students learn the skills historians use to study the past; analyzing primary and secondary sources, developing historical arguments, making historical comparisons, considering contextualization and causation, and focusing on continuity and change over

time. The course explores seven themes of U.S. history: American and national identity; migration and settlement; politics and power; work, exchange, and technology; the U.S. in the world; geography and the environment; and culture and society.

Civics (5532) (UC approved "a") Sem - 5 credits

This class is required for all 12th grade students

Civics encompasses a study of the American government system with emphasis on the structure, systems functions and powers of US government, as well as the rights and responsibilities of citizens to maintain a healthy democracy. Topics covered will include the basic legal system of the US; political affiliation, participation, and the voting process; executive, legislative and judicial branches of government, and individual rights. This course aims to prepare students for adulthood and to participate in our democracy. Class discussions, lectures, simulations, and problem solving through individual and group projects will be the dominant modes of instruction.

Economics (5541) (UC approved "g") Sem - 5 credits

This class is required for all 12th grade students

In Economics, students learn basic microeconomic concepts such as supply, demand, price and competition, along with fundamental economic analysis centered around trade-offs and opportunity cost. In addition, the course covers macroeconomic basics such as fiscal and monetary policies, the role of the government in the economy and the major economic indicators used to measure the well-being of the US economy. Students take a deep dive into land use economics through a redevelopment simulation called Urban Plan.

Ethnic Studies (5504) (UC approved "g") Sem - 5 credits

This course is open to 9th - 12th graders

Recommendation: This course is best suited for 9th & 10th graders

In Ethnic Studies, students will discuss issues of personal and cultural identity, as well as learn the history of modern social groups in America, explicitly within California. The course will go into greater depth of the non-dominant cultural narratives comparing the history and present-day experiences of a variety of "hyphenated Americans" (e.g. African Americans, Native Americans, Asian Americans). Through a social justice critical lens, students will watch documentaries, read books, and discuss articles that tell the true stories of our nation's history. Students will delve into current events that have shaped their high school experience, and prepare them for the world of tomorrow.

Financial Literacy and Personal Finance (5560) (UC approved "g") Sem - 5 credits

This course is open to 10 - 12th graders

Recommendation: This course is best suited for 11th & 12th graders

This semester-long course covers essential topics necessary to become a financially capable student. Students will develop a deeper understanding of personal finance topics and be prepared to handle the economic responsibilities of an independent young adult. We will use articles, videos, guided

discussions, and interactive activities created and supported by NGPF.org to define, explain, synthesize, and apply concepts and quantitative data to real-world contexts. Topics will include: Behavioral Economics, Consumer Skills, Budgeting, Banking, Investing, Career, Taxes, Credit, and Insurance. Additionally, student projects will also ask students to create a personal budget, participate in a virtual stock exchange project, and begin preparation for finding a job in the "real-world".

Law and Society (5556) (UC approved "g") Sem - 5 credits

This course is open to 10-12th graders
Recommendation: This course is best suited for 10th & 11th graders

Law and Society unlocks the door to a class where legal theory meets real-world application. It introduces students to various areas of law, including criminal and civil laws, beyond what is covered in US History and Civics. This course focuses on the foundations of law in any society, with specific attention to the US legal system, practices and current issues impacting our society. Students will learn about the criminal and civil legal system, the principles on which these systems are based, the role of the courts, the steps of a trial, legal defenses, individual rights and legal protections, criminal justice, real-life cases and much more! Mock trials, case studies, class discussions, interactive activities, guest speakers, educational podcasts and films, and lectures are the dominant modes of instruction. Students will develop critical thinking skills, explore ethical dilemmas and apply knowledge to real-world contexts. Students will gain a strong understanding of the laws and systems that shape our society and how we can make them better to achieve justice for all!

Psychology (5533) (UC approved "g") Year - 10 credits

This course is open to 10-12th graders
Recommendation: This course is best suited for 11th & 12th graders

This course is designed as an introduction to the basic principles of psychology with particular focus on biology's impact on behavior, states of consciousness, stages of development, learning/memory, intelligence, motivation, emotions, personality, clinical psychology, and social psychology. Lecture, interactive activities, self-tests, free-writes, guided group discussions, case studies, film, readings, and projects further student understanding of themselves and those around them. As students think critically about the material, they will have many opportunities to apply concepts and theories of human behavior to their own identities and experiences, as well as to broader real-world contexts. Students report that the curriculum is immediately and directly applicable to their lives.

School Publications

Introduction to Publications (5385) (UC approved "g") Sem - 5 credits

Not Offered 2026-2027 School Year
Recommendation: None

This course serves as a building block for production of the news magazine. It is open to both new students and returning staffers who wish to continue their skills with The Piedmont Highlander (TPH). The class focuses on the basics of news, features, sports, op/ed writing, as well as layout and design basics for both print and online journalism. New students are trained in news media journalism skills and

yearbook techniques while returning staffers/editors guide them toward publishing their work in these publications. Students also learn about the history of journalism, the first amendment, and the ethical decisions that all publications face. Students have an opportunity to take field trips to professional newspapers as well as national journalism conventions. The course is designed to lead into Journalism. Students will receive an application after they have completed the scheduling request form.

Journalism (7219) (UC approved "g") Year - 10 credits

Recommendation: completion of previous English class with a grade of B or higher
This course is open to 9th-12th graders

This course expands students' English and journalism skills through creating, designing, marketing, and publishing the student newspaper, The Piedmont Highlander, TPH, as well as using technology to enhance the paper through its online presence, TPHnews.com. Students are required to write for each issue of the paper, as well as for an outside source. Students become well versed in all types of journalistic writing as well as the basics of design and photography. Students have additional projects involving history, ethics, and in-depth reporting, and examine other professional media sources for story possibilities, as well as critiquing the design and content. Students who choose to take the class for more than one year can move into editor roles with advanced leadership positions.

More about The Piedmont Highlander (https://phs.piedmont.k12.ca.us/campus-life/school-newspaper)

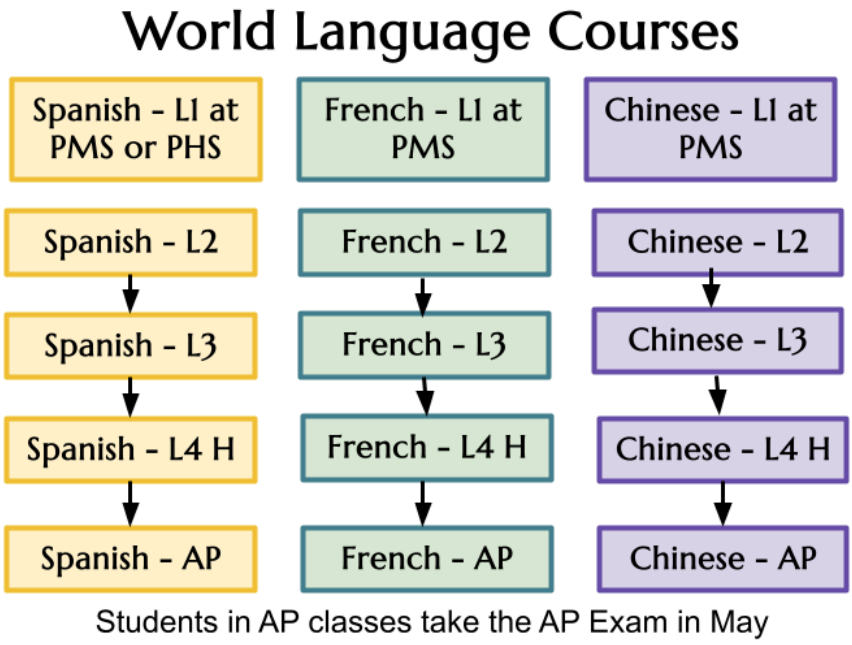
The Piedmont Highlander online (https://www.tphnews.com)

Photojournalism (Yearbook) (5355) (UC approved "g") Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: None. This course is open to 9th-12th graders

This is a year-long course which combines the high-level critical thinking, reading and writing skills of print journalism with the artistic, creative, and aesthetic skills of the visual and graphic arts. Students study techniques for reading, writing, photography, graphic design, interviewing and editing, as well as furthering their research skills. This course provides students with the expertise necessary to design and produce a year-end journalistic volume of student photography, research and writing that commemorates and covers the rich and diverse student experiences at Piedmont High School.

World Languages



World Language Mission Statement: It is our mission to equip our students to become interculturally competent, responsible global citizens who have the ability to communicate in the target language, value different cultures and perspectives, and who strive to achieve their full potential.

French Level 1	**(5410)**	**Level 2 (5415)**	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**
Chinese Level 1	**(5405)**	**Level 2 (5406)**	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**
Spanish Level 1	**(5440)**	**Level 2 (5445)**	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**

Recommendation for Level 1: Enrollment based on student request
Prerequisite for Level 2: Completion of semester 2 in Level 1 or BC with a grade of C or higher

First and second year world language students develop basic skills in the three modes of communication: Interpretive, Interpersonal and Presentational (reading/listening, speaking/writing) in the target language. The target proficiency level according to the ACTFL Proficiency Guidelines for Level 1 is Novice Mid, and Novice High for Level 2. Through interpretation of authentic resources, storytelling, role-playing, dialogues, simulations, and other communicative activities, students learn to use the language and explore the cultures of the target language countries. Our courses are designed to develop proficiency in communicating through the language, rather than memorization of isolated parts of the language. This course is intended for non-native speakers. For more information, see the Languages Other than English (E) section of the UC A-G policy resource guide and ACTFL.org. A donation towards the cost of Chinese workbooks and/or French/Spanish magazines is requested during online registration and can be made via Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

French Level 3 (5420)	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**
Chinese Level 3 (5408)	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**
Spanish Level 3 (5450)	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**

Prerequisite: Successful completion of semester 2 in Level 2 with a grade of C or higher or instructor's approval/recommendation

Third-year world language students continue developing skills in Interpretive, Interpersonal, and Presentational Communication (reading/listening, speaking/writing) in the target language. The target proficiency level according to the ACTFL Proficiency Guidelines for Level 3 is Intermediate Low. As students progress through the succeeding years of foreign language, there is advancement in the study and practice of speaking, reading, listening and writing. Deeper exploration of authentic resources, such as newspaper articles, plays, internet resources and poetry that reflect the culture is continued in the third year. Although there is increasing emphasis on accuracy at this level, our courses are designed to develop proficiency in communicating through the language, rather than memorization of isolated parts of the language. These courses are intended for non-native speakers. For more information, see the Languages Other than English (E) section of the UC A-G policy resource guide and ACTFL.org. A donation towards the cost of Chinese workbooks and/or French/Spanish magazines is requested during online registration and can be made via Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

French 4 Honors (5428)	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**
Chinese 4 Honors (5402)	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**
Spanish 4 Honors (5465)	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**

Prerequisite: Successful completion of semester 2 in Level 3 with a grade of C or higher or instructor's approval/recommendation

Level 4 Honors are pre-college level courses meant to develop advanced skills in Interpretive, Interpersonal, and Presentational Communication (reading/listening, writing/speaking) in the target language and develop more sophisticated cultural proficiency. **These courses are conducted in the target language, and students are expected to speak using the target language during class.** The target proficiency level according to the ACTFL Proficiency Guidelines for Level 4 is Intermediate Mid. These courses make extensive use of authentic materials such as online newspaper articles, videos, films, fiction and nonfiction (i.e., biographies and literature). These courses develop critical thinking skills and advanced literacy in the target language. Although there is an increased emphasis on accuracy at this level, our courses are designed to develop proficiency in communicating through the language, rather than memorization of isolated parts of the language. These courses are intended for non-native speakers. For more information, see the Languages Other than English (E) section of the UC A-G policy resource guide and ACTFL.org. A donation towards the cost of Chinese workbooks and/or French/Spanish magazines is requested during online registration and can be made via Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

AP French	**(5435)**	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**
AP Chinese	**(5402)**	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**
AP Spanish	**(5465)**	**(UC approved "e")**	**Year - 10 credits**

Prerequisite: Completion of semester 2 in Level 4 with a grade of C or higher or instructor's approval/recommendation

AP courses are college-level courses meant to teach advanced skills in Interpretive, Interpersonal, and Presentational Communication (reading/listening, writing/speaking) in the target language and cultural proficiency. The courses are primarily designed to prepare students for the College Board Advanced Placement Examination in the target language. **These courses are conducted in the target language, and students are expected to speak using the target language during class.** The target proficiency level according to the ACTFL Proficiency Guidelines for Level 5 (AP) is Intermediate High. These courses develop critical thinking skills and advanced literacy in the target language. These courses make extensive use of authentic materials such as online newspaper articles, videos, films, fiction and nonfiction (i.e., biographies and literature). Although there is an increased emphasis on accuracy at this level, our courses are designed to develop proficiency in communicating through the language, rather than memorization of isolated parts of the language. AP courses are the most advanced level offered and are considered a 5th year course. For more information, see the Languages Other than English (E) section of the UC A-G policy resource guide, College Board and ACTFL.org. A donation towards the cost of Chinese workbooks and/or French/Spanish magazines is requested during online registration and can be made via Infinite Campus in the Fees section.

Non-Departmental Courses

AP Seminar (5961) (UC approved “b”) Year - 10 credits

Open to 10th - 12th graders

AP Seminar is a foundational course that engages students in cross-curricular conversations that explore the complexities of academic and real-world topics and issues by analyzing divergent perspectives. Using an inquiry framework, students practice reading and analyzing articles, research studies, and foundational, literary, and philosophical texts; listening to and viewing speeches, broadcasts, and personal accounts; and experiencing artistic works and performances. Students learn to synthesize information from multiple sources, develop their own perspectives in written essays, and design and deliver oral and visual presentations, both individually and as part of a team. Ultimately, the course aims to equip students with the power to analyze and evaluate information with accuracy and precision in order to craft and communicate evidence-based arguments.

AP Research (5965) (UC approved “b”) Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: AP Seminar

AP Research, the second course in the AP Capstone™ experience, allows students to deeply explore an academic topic, problem, issue, or idea of individual interest.

Students design, plan, and implement a yearlong investigation to address a research question. Through this inquiry, they further the skills they acquired in the AP Seminar course by learning research methodology, employing ethical research practices, and accessing, analyzing, and synthesizing information. Students reflect on their skill development, document their processes, and curate the artifacts of their scholarly work through a process and reflection portfolio.

The course culminates in an academic paper of 4,000–5,000 words (accompanied by a performance, exhibit, or product where applicable) and a presentation with an oral defense.

AP Business with Personal Finance (5565) (UC approved “b”) Year - 10 credits

Open to 10th - 12th graders

AP Business with Personal Finance is a yearlong high school business and personal finance course that aligns closely with a college-level introduction to business course. Students explore the business disciplines of entrepreneurship, marketing, finance, accounting, and management through real-world business applications, case studies, and project based learning. In addition, students learn and apply all the National Standards for Personal Financial Education created by the Council for Economic Education and the Jump$tart Coalition for Personal Financial Literacy.

Affinity Mentorship (3000) (not UC approved) Year - 10 credits

Prerequisites: None

The Affinity Mentorship Course is a district-proposed and district-led course proposed to meet a need identified in the Racial Equity Board Policy; however, the origin of the course is the Piedmont Affinity and Mentor Program created and led by Jean Chen Takazawa in collaboration with Ina Bendich.

The course is designed to bring MHS and PHS students from similar cultural, ethnic, religious, and gender expansive backgrounds together with their elementary students at Beach, Havens, Wildwood, and Piedmont Middle School. The goal of this course is to honor and celebrate the diversity of our student body and to create safe spaces for young students to have role models that share their similar identities. We will do this in affinity groups where mentors foster conversation and community in a positive way. We teach our high school mentors the basics of Restorative Justice circles as an avenue to foster these conversations around our shared identity. We will form affinity groups with younger students based on who enrolls in our program at the elementary and middle school level. We will match high school mentors with younger students where they meet 2-3 times per month outside of course time. During this time together, mentors will lead conversations in an age-appropriate way. We will use books, videos, music, art and inspirational role models to help celebrate our diverse backgrounds.

The course will meet one day per week, either during 1st period or 8th period. The term “8th period” means at a time scheduled outside of the school day but is not an official time attached to the time when school ends. The course will be graded on a Pass/No Pass basis. Sign up for this elective course with your school counselor. The course may be repeated.

Guitar Engineering (5863) (UC approved “d”) Year - 10 credits

Prerequisite: Completion of Chemistry in the Earth System/Honors Chemistry in the Earth System, IM2

This course looks at the design elements, manufacturing and assembly of solid-body electric guitars. Science, technology and engineering (STEM) concepts that relate directly to guitars are used to help students make an applied learning connection. Each student will construct their own electric guitar. The course will cover wood species and the environment, guitar headstock design features, chemistry of finishes, math applications in a guitar, physical science aspects of the guitar such as concepts of sound waves, string tension, fretboard layout, intonation, and electronics. Studio-style class, lecture and lab time combined throughout the course.

A large component of the course involves building skills in the shop and life skills. Students will be in an environment that fosters confidence and encourages students to take risks. For example, designing and building a speaker will allow students to practice soldering, making circuits and using the laser cutter before they utilize these skills on their guitars. Students need practice so they can take risks in a controlled environment prior to their build.

A donation towards laboratory fees is requested during online registration and can be made in Infinite Campus in the Fees section. Please note that the $400 donation for this course is for the cost of the guitar, speaker, and associated equipment. Students who do not donate may not keep their guitar at the conclusion of the class.

Leadership/ASB (5985) — Year - 10 credits

Prerequisites: None

The Associated Student Body Leadership class is comprised of elected and appointed student council students grades 9th through 12th. This leadership council acts as a voice for the student body and a bridge between communities in order to create and sustain an enjoyable, enriching high school experience for all members of the Associated Student Body. The council is responsible for such events as organizing the school-wide student senate, planning rallies and dances, promoting clubs, and heading fundraisers and drives throughout the year.

Health Science (5535) — Sem - 5 credits

Prerequisites: None

Health Science is a discovery course that focuses on helping teens arrive at informed decisions about how to take responsibility for their health and behavior. Topics explored include health and wellness, managing stress, resisting peer pressure, communication skills, healthy relationships, human sexuality, sexually transmitted diseases, diversity, identity, and drug and alcohol abuse.

Note: Per Board action on October 22, 2025, Health Science is no longer a graduation requirement. Starting with the class of 2030, students will receive the components of the California Healthy Youth Act in 9th grade PE. Students who do not take 9th grade PE at PHS must show proof of completing the components of California Healthy Youth Act.

For the class of 2029 specifically, students will be provided the components necessary under the California Healthy Youth Act from April 27 to May 8 in their PE/Dance classes. Students may still take the Health Science class as an elective, but it will not be needed as a graduation requirement. [Updated 1/7/26]

Learning Center (6030 - 6050) — Sem - 5 credits

Prerequisite: Students must meet state eligibility criteria for special education

The Learning Center program provides individualized, structured instruction and focused academic support based on students' educational needs and their IEP.

Food Service Assistant (5906S1, 5906S2) — Sem - 5 credits

Recommendation: None

A practical experience for students, Food Service TAs learn skills in baking, cookery, food safety, teamwork, multi-tasking, time-management, and cleaning as you go. Food Service TAs receive real-life on the job training.

Teacher/Office Assistant (5911) Sem - 5 credits

A practical experience for students in most areas of PHS. Placement is by mutual agreement between teacher and student. Students are expected to develop communication skills, the ability to work with others and independently, develop employability skills, and understand the need for confidentiality. A letter grade or pass/fail credit may be issued at the discretion of the teacher. General locations for TAs are the Main Office, Library, or PHS teachers. Office experiences include meeting the public, telephone etiquette, using office equipment properly and safely, filling out forms, making copies, filing, and delivering notes/passes to classrooms. Teacher assistant experiences may also include preparation of teaching materials, filing, organizing materials, collating materials, distributing materials, setting up labs, assisting with course work, helping individual students, shelving books, and other duties as requested.

Unscheduled (Free Periods) (7000S1, 7000S2) Sem - 0 credits

An unscheduled class period at the beginning or end of the day may be used as extra time for sleep, study, or work. Students may request morning or afternoon unscheduled periods, but no guarantee can be made that they will receive the period they request, due to placement of other classes in the master schedule. Upperclassmen are given first priority.

Dual Enrollment

Dual enrollment provides Piedmont High School students the opportunity to take community college classes while in high school on our high school campus (most of the time). These classes are advanced in nature, providing coursework beyond what is offered by Piedmont High School Staff and are not designed to replace high school graduation requirements.

Piedmont High School staff will assist students and parents with this process but it should be made clear that these are college classes and students will be treated as college students. As such, the following should be noted:

- Add and drop deadlines, including dropping with and without a “W” will be strictly dependent on the deadlines imposed by the community college for which the course being taken is articulated with.
- Access to student progress, including grades, will not be available to school staff or parents. As college students, only they will be able to see/monitor their grades.
- Most/all coursework at the college level is done via Canvas. This includes communications with professors, assignments, meetings (if done virtually), etc.
- Dual enrollment courses will follow the college calendar for which the courses are articulated
    - Classes are typically 16 weeks.
    - Spring break at the college level does not typically align with Piedmont High School. As such, students should be cognizant of attendance requirements should they take a dual enrollment course.
- Services related to Special Education do not matriculate to the college level. Piedmont High School does not have authority in this space post-high school. We can put students in touch with the college and the SAS (Student Accessibility Services) office at the pertinent community college for which the course is being articulated with.
- 504 Services may be different at the college level. Piedmont High School does not have authority in this space post-high school. We can put students in touch with the college and the SAS (Student Accessibility Services) office at the pertinent community college for which the course is being articulated with.
- Most fees are waived including but not limited to, tuition, enrollment, transportation, and student representation fees. The college may impose a health service fee and parking fee (optional).
- Students are responsible for textbook costs. Prices can range from $0 (professors that participate in ZTC-zero textbook cost-program) to over $100 per class, per semester.
- Dual enrollment courses are considered “closed” to students of Piedmont High School, so long as enrollment targets are met.
    - Should Piedmont High School not meet the enrollment targets, the college may open enrollment to the public.
- Dual enrollment courses will likely be offered during the last period of the day (6th or 7th period).
    - They typically follow college format–90 minutes to 2 hours, twice a week.
        - 5 unit courses may meet more frequently/longer
    - As such, dual enrollment classes may run on T/Th or W/F.
- More information can be found here: https://www.cccco.edu/About-Us/Chancellors-Office/Divisions/Educational-Services-and-Support/What-we-do/Dual-Enrollment

The following Dual Enrollment Courses will be considered and listed for course signups.

Calculus III: Partial Differentiation (5662)

Semester - 5 college credits

Prerequisite: AP Calculus BC with AP Score of 3 or higher

Course Description: Partial differentiation: Jacobians, transformations, multiple integrals, theorems of Green and Stokes, differential forms, vectors and vector functions, geometric coordinates and vector calculus.

Student Performance Objectives (Exit Skills):

1. Perform algebraic operations on vectors.
2. Apply vector operations to various types of problems involving lines and planes.
3. Compute and apply partial derivatives.
4. Compute multiple integrals.
5. Apply multiple integrals.
6. Demonstrate satisfactory understanding of the concepts which provide the foundation for the skills outlined above in order to continue work in mathematics and to apply these principles to related fields.
7. Demonstrate the ability to think logically through assessing given information, exploring alternative approaches, and arriving at conclusions based on evidence and the application of applicable concepts.

Course Content:

1. Algebraic operations on vectors: 20%
    a. Algebra of vectors
    b. Vectors in TR3
    c. Dot product of two vectors
    d. Cross product of two vectors
    e. Lines and planes
2. Partial derivatives: 20%
    a. Graphs of equations
    b. Functions and level curves
    c. Partial derivatives
    d. The differential
    e. The chain rule
    f. The directional derivative and the gradient
    g. Critical points and extrema
3. Definite integral over plane and solid regions: 20%
    a. Double integrals in rectangular coordinates
    b. Double integrals in polar coordinates
    c. Triple integrals in rectangular coordinates
    d. Triple integrals in cylindrical coordinates
    e. Triple integrals in spherical coordinates
    f. Coordinate transformation and the Jacobian
4. The derivative of a vector function: 20%
    a. Properties of the derivative of a vector function

   b. Tangent planes
   c. Acceleration vectors
   d. The unit vectors T and N
5. Green's Theorem, the divergence Theorem, Stokes' Theorem: 20%
   a. Vector and scalar fields
   b. Line integrals
   c. Conservative vector fields
   d. Green's Theorem
   e. Surface integrals
   f. The divergence Theorem
   g. Stoke's Theorem.

Differential Equations: Ordinary Differential Equations (5663) Semester - 3 college credits
Prerequisite: Calculus III with a C or higher

Topics in ODE includes, but is not limited to:

- Basic concepts:
  - Definition of an ODE, dependent and independent variables, order of an ODE.
  - Classification of ODEs: linear vs. nonlinear, homogeneous vs. nonhomogeneous.
- Solving first-order ODEs:
  - Separable equations
  - Linear equations (integrating factor method)
  - Exact equations
  - Homogeneous equations
- Solving higher-order linear ODEs:
  - Characteristic equations
  - Method of undetermined coefficients
  - Variation of parameters
- Qualitative analysis:
  - Direction fields
  - Equilibrium solutions and stability
  - Phase plane analysis
- Numerical methods for solving ODEs:
  - Euler's method
  - Improved Euler's method
  - Runge-Kutta methods
- Applications of ODEs:
  - Population dynamics
  - Circuit analysis
  - Mechanics (projectile motion, damped oscillations)
  - Chemical reactions

Linear Algebra (5664)

Semester - 3 college credits

Prerequisite: AP Calculus AB or higher with AP score of 3 or higher

Linear algebra primarily covers topics like vectors, matrices, vector spaces, linear equations, systems of equations, linear transformations, eigenvalues, eigenvectors, matrix operations (addition, multiplication, inverses), determinants, linear independence, and concepts like projections and singular value decomposition, all used to solve systems of linear equations and analyze linear relationships between variables.

Important topics:

- Eigenvalues and eigenvectors: Special values and vectors associated with a matrix that reveal important information about linear transformations.
- Linear independence: Whether a set of vectors can be combined to create other vectors.
- Matrix operations: Addition, multiplication, finding inverses, and determinants.
- Linear transformations: Functions that preserve the structure of vector spaces.
- Solving systems of equations: Using matrices to find solutions to sets of linear equations.

Discrete Mathematics (5665)

Semester - 4 college credits

Prerequisite: AP Calculus BC or higher with AP score of 3 or higher

Discrete mathematics covers the study of mathematical structures that involve "discrete" objects, meaning objects with distinct, separate values, including topics like set theory, graph theory, logic, combinatorics, basic counting techniques, and sometimes probability, where the focus is on countable sets rather than continuous values like real numbers found in calculus; essentially, it deals with structures that can be counted individually, making it highly relevant to computer science due to the digital nature of computers.

Key areas covered in discrete math:
Set theory: Basic operations on sets, relations between sets, functions, and their properties.
Logic: Propositional logic, predicate logic, proof techniques like proof by contradiction, induction.
Combinatorics: Counting techniques like permutations, combinations, the pigeonhole principle.
Graph theory: Analyzing relationships between objects using graphs, including concepts like paths, cycles, connectivity, and algorithms on graphs.
Recursions: Defining sequences and problems based on previous terms
Basic probability: Discrete probability distributions, calculating probabilities of events in discrete settings.

Small Business Management (5570)

Semester - 3 college credits

Prerequisite: None

This course introduces students to the fundamentals of managing a small business in today’s competitive environment. Emphasis is placed on entrepreneurial decision-making, operations, marketing, finance, and growth strategies. Students will develop practical skills through case studies, simulations, and the creation of a business management plan.

Course Objectives

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

1. Identify the unique challenges and opportunities facing small business owners.
2. Apply principles of planning, organizing, leading, and controlling in a small business context.
3. Evaluate financing options and financial management strategies for small enterprises.
4. Develop marketing strategies suitable for small-scale businesses.
5. Analyze growth strategies, succession planning, and exit strategies.
6. Create a practical management plan for a small business.

Note: Some dual enrollment course descriptions were written with generative AI pending actual course descriptions from articulated colleges.